Indie Devs Documentation

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1. Introduction

ArtistConnect is a web-based platform designed to help independent artists share their creative work and build meaningful relationships with their audiences. Artists often rely on several separate services to publish media, announce events, and communicate with supporters. Fans, meanwhile, may find it difficult to discover emerging artists in their own communities.

ArtistConnect brings these activities together in one place. Artists can maintain profiles, publish multimedia posts, create events, and interact with fans. Fans can search for artists by name, style, or location, follow creators, and engage with their content. Administrators support a safe community by reviewing reports and managing accounts. The project aims to make independent creative communities easier to discover, participate in, and sustain.

2. Project Overview

ArtistConnect provides a shared online environment for independent artists, fans, and platform administrators. Its core capabilities include artist discovery, multimedia publishing, event promotion, community interaction, direct messaging, and content moderation. Rather than focusing on a single medium, the platform accommodates different kinds of creative work and emphasizes connections between artists and their local audiences.

2.1 Product Perspective

ArtistConnect is intended to operate as a standalone web application accessible through a browser. The user interface provides distinct workflows for artists, fans, and administrators. The envisioned system uses an application layer to handle business rules and a database to store user accounts, artist profiles, posts, events, and relationships between users. The project also anticipates deployment through a cloud hosting service.

The current user-interface previews demonstrate representative workflows, including creating a post, searching for artists, and creating an event. These previews illustrate the intended user experience; browser-local demonstration data should not be mistaken for completed backend persistence, live notifications, or deployed production functionality.

2.2 Assumptions and Dependencies

The project assumes that users can access a modern web browser and that registered accounts will be associated with appropriate roles and permissions. Artist discovery depends on artists providing searchable profile information, such as their name, creative style, and location. Event creation depends on artists supplying sufficient event details, and publication of ticket pricing may require administrative approval.

The full system depends on the availability of backend services, persistent data storage, and hosting infrastructure. Multimedia uploads will also require suitable file validation and storage. Features involving live messaging, notifications, recommendations, or automated moderation may depend on additional services and must be distinguished from functionality demonstrated only in the interface prototype.

3. Requirements Analysis

Customer / Stakeholder Perspective: Small independent artists need a platform to host their art and foster deeper connections with their fan communities. As an artist, I want a hybrid social media and art hosting site to upload my music, images, and stories, promote events, and interact directly with my supporters through messages and videos. As a fan, I want to discover new artists near me, follow their updates, attend their shows, and interact with other members of the community. As an administrator, I need tools to moderate the platform, review applications, and keep the community safe.

Functional Requirements:

- The system must support role-based access control with distinct permissions and workflows for Fans, Artists, and Administrators.
- The system must allow Artists to maintain a profile, upload multimedia content (music, art images, stories, videos), and promote their events.
- The system must enable Fans to maintain an "about" profile and discover new artists using a proximity-based radius search.
- The system must provide a messaging infrastructure allowing fans to message artists and each other.
- The system must allow Administrators to review prospective artist applications, respond to user reports, and manage/ban accounts violating the Terms of Service (ToS).
- The system must allow Fans to submit appeals on their ban decisions and have an Admin other than the one who initially banned them review the appeals requests.

Non-Functional Requirements / Environment:

- The system must be a web-based application utilizing a 3-tier architecture (frontend web server, backend application layer, and database) to handle persistence and advanced business logic.
- The system must be deployed to a cloud hosting service such as Google Cloud Platform (GCP), Amazon Web Services (AWS), or Microsoft Azure.
- The development lifecycle must incorporate a CI/CD pipeline with mandatory pull requests.
- Any optional AI functionalities (e.g., content moderation, recommendation engines, or AI-generated art detectors) must be designed to respect user privacy, include human oversight, and feature fallback behavior.

4. User Story

- **[US-01]** As a **Fan**, I want to **search for artists using a proximity-based radius** so that **I can discover and attend local shows**. *(Maps to UC: Search for Artist)*
- **[US-02]** As a **Fan**, I want to **receive artist recommendations** so that **I can easily find new creators similar to the ones I already enjoy**. *(Maps to UC: Receive Recommendation)*
- **[US-03]** As an **Artist**, I want to **create posts with multimedia content (music, images, videos)** so that **I can share my art and stories with my fan community**. *(Maps to UC: Make a Post)*
- **[US-04]** As a **Fan**, I want to **comment on an artist's uploaded artwork or posts** so that **I can show my support and engage with the community**. *(Maps to UC: Comment on Artwork)*
- **[US-05]** As an **Artist**, I want to **monitor and manage the comments on my posts** so that **I can hide inappropriate content and report abusive users to admins**. *(Maps to UC: Monitor Comments)*
- **[US-06]** As a **User (Fan or Artist)**, I want to **send direct messages to other users** so that **I can privately communicate, collaborate, or socialize**. *(Maps to UC: Message Another User)*
- **[US-07]** As an **Artist**, I want to **create and promote upcoming events** so that **my fans know when and where to see my shows**. *(Maps to UC: Create Event)*
- **[US-08]** As an **Artist**, I want to **edit and update my existing event information** so that **my fans have the most accurate and current details if plans change**. *(Maps to UC: Update Event)*
- **[US-09]** As an **Administrator**, I want to **approve prospective artist verification applications** so that **I can ensure only legitimate, non-fake artists are granted the Artist role**. *(Maps to UC: Approve Artist Verification Application)*
- **[US-10]** As an **Administrator**, I want to **review conduct reports submitted by users** so that **I can make fair moderation decisions regarding inappropriate content**. *(Maps to UC: Review Report)*
- **[US-11]** As an **Administrator**, I want to **suspend or ban user accounts that violate the terms of service** so that **the platform remains a safe environment for artists and fans**. *(Maps to UC: Suspending Artist Account)*

- **[US-12]** As an **Administrator**, I want to **review and process ban appeals from fans** so that **I can reverse unfair or incorrect bans made by the system or other admins**. *(Maps to UC: Unban Fan)*

5. Key Technical Challenges

- **AI Feature Integration:** Integrating machine learning for moderation and recommendations poses performance and privacy challenges.
  Approach: Decouple AI processing from core traffic using scalable REST APIs and implement heuristic fallbacks to ensure uptime if models fail.
- **3-Tier Cloud Deployment:** Managing a frontend, backend, database, and strict CI/CD pipeline requires significant DevOps overhead.
  Approach: Establish automated testing and mandatory pull requests early, utilizing managed cloud services (GCP, AWS, or Azure) to minimize infrastructure management.

Key Risks

- **Scope Creep:** The extensive feature set (hybrid media, messaging, AI) risks exceeding the semester timeframe.
  Mitigation: Strictly prioritize core workflows (authentication, media, messaging) over optional AI features using agile sprints.
- **Content Moderation:** User-generated media and messaging introduce risks of Terms of Service violations.
  Mitigation: Implement robust user-reporting systems, Admin review workflows, and automated moderation filters.

Competition

- **SoundCloud:** *What it does well:* Excellent audio hosting, discovery, and timestamped comments.
  Where it falls short: Lacks visual art hosting, video interactions, and proximity-based local discovery.
- **Instagram:** *What it does well:* Massive reach for visual art, short-form videos, and messaging.
  Where it falls short: Not tailored to independent artists, lacks high-quality audio hosting, and prioritizes viral content over local community connections.

6. What's New?

Existing platforms generally focus on a single medium (e.g., SoundCloud) or cater to broad audiences (e.g., Instagram). Our project introduces a **hybrid platform tailored explicitly for small, independent, multi-disciplinary artists**.

Key Differentiators:

- **Multi-Disciplinary Hub:** Consolidates high-quality audio, visual art, and video hosting into a single profile.
- **Proximity-Based Discovery:** Replaces viral-chasing algorithms with a location-based search to foster real-world, local community connections.
- **Authenticity & Safety Focus:** Proposes specialized AI tools—like AI-generated art detectors and privacy-respecting moderation—to maintain a secure, human-centric ecosystem dedicated to independent art.

7. Use Cases

Actors Overview

- **Fan** – discovers and follows artists, messages them, and books events.
- **Artist** – manages a public profile, proposes events, and communicates with fans.
- **Admin** – moderates content and accounts by reviewing user-filed reports.

7.1 Alejandro Garcia Jr – Use Cases

7.1.1 UC: Search for Artist – Fan

Primary Actor
Fan

Scope ArtistConnect chat application

Level User goal

Stakeholders & Interests
- **Fan:** wants to quickly find artists matching their interests, including artists close by.
- **Artist:** wants to be discoverable by relevant fans in their area.

Preconditions
- The Fan is authenticated with a Fan account in good standing. Artists and Admins cannot perform this use case.

Postconditions (Success Guarantee)
- A list of artists matching every criterion the Fan entered was displayed.
- If the Fan chose a distance, only artists within that distance were listed, nearest first, each with its distance.
- No system data was created or changed.

Main Success Scenario
1. The Fan selects the search feature.
2. The system prompts the Fan for search criteria: name, genre/style, location, and an optional distance (e.g., "within 25 km of me").
3. The Fan enters one or more criteria and submits the search.
4. The system finds registered artists matching all of the given criteria.
5. The system displays the matching artists, each showing name, genre, location, profile thumbnail, and distance when a distance was chosen.

Extensions *a. The user is not signed in with an active Fan account: the system denies the search.

3a. The Fan submits the search with no criteria entered: the system prompts the Fan to enter at least one criterion.

3b. The Fan chooses a distance and shares their current location: the system searches around the shared location instead of the Fan's saved home location.

3c. The Fan chooses a distance but has neither shared a location nor saved a home location: the system asks the Fan to share their location or save a home location.

4a. No artists match the given criteria: the system displays a "no results found" message and suggests broadening the search (e.g., a larger distance).

Special Requirements
- Search results should be returned in under 2 seconds for typical query loads.
- Result lists longer than 20 artists are paginated.
- A Fan's location is used only to run the search and is never shown to other users.

Frequency of Occurrence
High – expected to be one of the most common Fan actions.

Notes Viewing an artist's profile, following, messaging, or booking an artist from the results are separate use cases.

7.1.2 UC: Review Report – Admin

Primary Actor
Admin

Scope ArtistConnect chat application

Level User goal

Stakeholders & Interests
- **Admin:** needs enough context to make a fair, auditable moderation decision.
- **Reporting user (Fan or Artist):** wants inappropriate content or behavior addressed.
- **Reported user (Fan or Artist):** has an interest in fair treatment and being informed of any action taken.

Preconditions
- The Admin is authenticated with administrative privileges.
- At least one report exists with status "Pending," filed by a Fan or an Artist against a message, profile, or event.

Postconditions (Success Guarantee)
- The report's status was updated to "Resolved," with the decision and acting Admin recorded.
- Any moderation action taken (dismiss, warn, delete content, suspend/ban account) was applied to the reported content or account.
- Both the reporting user and the reported user were notified of the outcome.

Main Success Scenario 1. The Admin opens the reports queue.

2. The system displays pending reports, each showing the reporter, reported content or user, reason, and timestamp.
3. The Admin selects a report to review.
4. The system displays full report details, including the reported message, profile, or event, and the reporter's stated reason.
5. The Admin evaluates the report and selects an action: dismiss, warn the user, delete the content, or suspend/ban the account.
6. The system applies the selected action.
7. The system records the resolution (Admin identity, action taken, timestamp) and sets the report status to "Resolved."
8. The system notifies the reporting user that their report was reviewed, and notifies the reported user of any action taken against them.

Extensions *a. The user is not signed in with an active Admin account: the system denies access to the reports queue.

3a. The selected report was already resolved by another Admin: the system informs the Admin and returns to the queue.

5a. The Admin dismisses the report as unfounded: the system records the dismissal and notifies only the reporting user.

5b. The Admin suspends or bans the reported user's account: the account can no longer perform any Fan or Artist actions until it is restored.

5c. The Admin chooses to delete content on a report against a user profile: the system explains that only warn, suspend, or ban apply to user reports.

6a. The reported content was already removed (e.g., deleted by its owner): the system notes this and proceeds directly to logging the resolution.

Special Requirements
- The reports queue must support filtering by report type (message, profile, or event).
- All resolutions must be permanently logged for audit purposes.

Frequency of Occurrence
Low to moderate – driven by user-filed reports rather than a routine action.

7.1.3 UC: Create Event – Artist

Primary Actor
Artist

Scope ArtistConnect chat application

Level User goal

Stakeholders & Interests
- **Artist:** wants to promote and sell tickets to an upcoming event.
- **Admin:** wants submitted events to be complete and valid before reviewing their pricing.
- **Fan:** wants accurate, trustworthy event listings.

Preconditions • The Artist is authenticated with an Artist account in good standing (not suspended or banned) and has an artist profile. Fans and Admins cannot perform this use case.

Postconditions (Success Guarantee) • A new event was created, linked to the Artist, with status "Pending Approval" (or "Draft" if the Artist saved it as a draft).

• The event appears in the Artist's list of events.

Main Success Scenario 1. The Artist selects "Create Event."

2. The system displays the event creation form.
3. The Artist enters the event details: title, date/time, location (physical address or virtual link), description, capacity, and one or more ticket tiers with prices.
4. The Artist submits the event.
5. The system validates the submitted data.
6. The system creates the event with status "Pending Approval."
7. The system confirms to the Artist that the event was submitted for review.

Extensions *a. The user is not signed in with an active Artist account: the system denies the request.

4a. The Artist saves the event as a draft instead of submitting: the system stores it with status "Draft" and confirms the draft was saved.

5a. Required fields are missing, the date is not in the future, the capacity is not positive, or a price is negative: the system flags the offending fields and asks the Artist to correct them, returning to step 3.

5b. The event is marked virtual but the location is not a valid web link: the system asks for a valid link, returning to step 3.

Special Requirements • Ticket pricing must support multiple tiers (e.g., general admission, VIP).

Frequency of Occurrence
Moderate – expected whenever an Artist plans a new event.

Notes An Admin reviewing and publishing the event is a separate use case (Review Event Pricing).

Repeat the section above for each additional team member, with their own 3 use cases in the same fully-dressed format.

7.2 Garrett DeYong – Use Cases

7.2.1 UC: Make a Post – Artist

Use case: Make a post
Actor: Artist
Preconditions:

1. The artist is logged in.
2. The artist is allowed to post.

Postconditions;

1. A new post belonging to the user is saved in the database.
2. This post can be viewed and commented on according to provided settings.

Main flow:

1. The artist selects the option to create a post.
2. The system prompts the artist to provide post content (text, files) and post permissions (whether it is public, whether it can be commented on).
3. The artist provides this information.
4. The system stores the post.
5. The system adds the post to the artist's account.

Extensions:

4a. No post content provided

4a1. The system determines no post content was provided.
4a2. The system prompts the sender to provide post content.

Special requirements:

- For public posts, the system should update the artist's profile content quickly (within 5 seconds, ideally).

7.2.2 UC: Message Another User (Beginning a New Conversation)

Use case: Message another user (beginning a new conversation)
Actor: User (artist or fan)
Preconditions:

1. The sender is logged in.
2. The sender is allowed to send messages.
3. The sender has accessed the recipient's page.
4. The recipient is accepting messages (both in general and from the sender specifically).
5. The sender and recipient do not currently have an ongoing conversation.

Postconditions:

1. A new conversation thread is established.

Main flow:

1. The sender selects the option on the recipients profile to begin a message.
2. The system prompts the sender to type the message.
3. The sender inputs the message.
4. The system checks and validates the message.
5. The system creates a new conversation thread with the provided message.
6. The system enables access to this thread to the sender and the recipient.

Extensions:

4a. Message empty

4a1. The system determines no message was provided.
4a2. The system prompts the sender to type the message.

4b. Message not appropriate/allowable

4b1. The system determines the message is not appropriate in some way.
4b2. The system warns the sender of this and prompts for message modifications.

Special requirements:

- The recipient should be notified that they have received a new message.

7.2.3 UC: Monitor Comments – Artist

Use case: Monitor comments
Actor: Artist
Preconditions:

1. The artist is logged in.
2. The artist has accessed the comment section of one of their posts.

Postconditions:

1. A given comment has been hidden from users.
2. Admins have been informed, if the artist so chooses.
3. The comment's author has been blocked, if the artist so chooses.

Main flow:

1. The artist selects the manage option on a comment.
2. The system prompts the artist to select the desired action (delete/report/block user).
3. The artist provides this information.
4. The system hides the comment from users.

Extensions:

4a. Report option selected

4a1. The system files a report after hiding the comment, to be viewed by admins.

4b. Block option selected

4b1. The system makes a request to prevent the user from interacting with the artist's posts in the future.

Special requirements:

- The system should not delete the comment from the database; it should be stored, but not visible to non-admin users.
- The comment should be hidden quickly (within 2 seconds, ideally).
- The user should be blocked (if applicable) quickly (within 2 seconds, ideally).
- The report (if applicable) should be sent within a few minutes.

7.3 Nicholas Nolen – Use Cases

7.3.1 UC: Update Event

Primary Actor
Artist

Scope Artist Home Page

Level User goal

Stakeholders & Interests
- **Fan:** As a fan I want to be able to view artist's most up to date event information.
- **Artist:** As an artist I want to provide up to date information about my events.

Preconditions
- An artist has logged into the system.
- An artist has already created an event.

Postconditions (Success Guarantee)
- An event has been updated on the artist's profile.

Main Success Scenario
1. The artist requests to modify an existing event.
2. The system prompts the artist to write over the event information (e.g. event type, description, date, time, relevant images/flyers).
3. The artist updates their event's information.
4. The system validates the input.
5. The system prompts the artist to review their updated event details.
6. The artist acknowledges they reviewed their details and submits the event.
7. The event shows up on the artist's profile to everyone who views it.

5a. Extensions Invalid input

- The system detects invalid input.
- The system displays an error message and requests the artist correct the issue.

6a. Artist fails to acknowledge

- The system displays an error message stating the artist must acknowledge they have reviewed the details of their submission before submitting.
- The artist acknowledges their review.
- The artist submits their event.

Frequency of Occurrence

Mdderate – It is expected for artists to make mistakes uploading event information.

7.3.2 UC: Unban Fan

Primary Actor

Admin

Scope Administrative service

Level System goal

Stakeholders & Interests

- **Admin:** As an admin I want to do my job and process appeals
- **Fan:** As a fan I want to be appealed to access the site.

Preconditions

- An Admin has logged into the system.
- A ban appeal has been made by a fan.

Postconditions (Success Guarantee)

- A different admin than the banning admin has reviewed the appeal.
- The appeal request has been processed and the fan is unbanned.

Main Success Scenario

1. The admin selects the option to review open appeals from bans performed by admin other than themselves.
2. The admin selects an appeal.
3. The admin reviews fan submitted reasoning for the appeal along with related report material along with an automated AI recommendation based on the ToS.
4. The admin selects an option to proceed with unbanning the user.
5. The system removes the user's ban.
6. The system grants the user the ability to log into the website.

Extensions 1a. No appeals

- The system shows no open appeals.
- The admin closes the reports tab.

5a. Appeal is invalid

- The admin selects an option to mark the appeal as invalid.
- The system logs the appeal as invalid and removes it from the open appeals list.

Frequency of Occurrence

High – There will likely always be fans trying to appeal bans.

7.3.3 UC: Recieve Reccomendation

Primary Actor
Fan

Scope Fan Home Page

Level User goal

Stakeholders & Interests
- **Fan:** As a fan I want to be able to find artists similar to those I like.
- **Artist:** As an artist I want to get my art out there to fans.

Preconditions
- A fan has logged into the system.
- A fan has previously interacted with artists on the platform.

Postconditions (Success Guarantee)
- A fan receives recommendations for artists they might like.

Main Success Scenario
1. A fan selects the option to display artists they might like.
2. The system retrieves the artists a fan has previously interacted with (e.g. viewed profiles, liking posts, commenting on posts, etc.).
3. The system utilizes an algorithm to determine artists similar to the fan's most interacted with artists.
4. The system displays a list of artists to the user.

Extensions 1a. New Fan
- The fan has logged into the system for the first time and does not have interactions.
- The system does not show the option to display artists they might like.

Frequency of Occurrence
High – It is likely fans will want frequent reccomendations.

7.4 Gan-Orgil Gantumur – Use Cases

7.4.1 UC: Suspending Artist Account – Admin

Use case: Suspending Artist Account
Actor: Administrator
Preconditions:

1. The Administrator is logged into the system.
2. A user account has been reported or flagged for potential terms of service (ToS) violations.

Postconditions:

1. The user's account is successfully suspended.
2. The system revokes the user's access and permissions.

Main flow:

1. The Administrator requests to view reported user accounts.
2. The system provides the pending reports and associated user activity.
3. The Administrator determines the user's actions violate the ToS.
4. The Administrator submits a request to suspend the user.
5. The system updates the account status to suspended and revokes the user's permissions.

Extensions:

3a. Report does not violate ToS

- 3a1. The Administrator determines the user's actions do not violate the ToS.
- 3a2. The Administrator dismisses the report, and the system maintains the account's active status.

7.4.2 UC: Comment on Artwork – Fan

Use case: Comment on Artwork
Actor: Fan
Preconditions:

1. The Fan is logged in with "user" role permissions.
2. An Artist has published media that allows comments.

Postconditions:

1. The Fan's comment is saved and published on the Artist's post.

Main flow:

1. The Fan requests to add a comment to an Artist's media.
2. The system prompts the Fan for the comment content.
3. The Fan provides the comment content.
4. The system validates the comment against business rules.
5. The system saves and publishes the comment to the Artist's page.

Extensions:

4a. Content flagged by system business rules

- 4a1. The system determines the content violates business rules (e.g., via basic word filters or optional AI-based content moderation, if enabled).
- 4a2. The system rejects the comment and notifies the Fan.

5a. Inappropriate comment reported post-publication

- 5a1. An Artist monitors their comments and identifies a published comment as inappropriate.
- 5a2. The Artist submits a report regarding the comment for Administrator review.

7.4.3 UC: Approve Artist Verification Application – Admin

Use case: Approve Artist Verification Application
Actor: Administrator
Preconditions:

1. The Administrator is logged in and authorized to manage accounts.
2. A user has submitted an application to upgrade to the Artist role.

Postconditions:

1. The user's application is resolved (approved or rejected).
2. If approved, the user is granted the Artist role and associated permissions.

Main flow:

1. The Administrator requests pending Artist verification applications.
2. The system provides the submitted application materials.
3. The Administrator evaluates the application to verify the applicant's identity.
4. The Administrator approves the application.
5. The system assigns the user the "Artist" role and updates their permissions.

Extensions:

3a. Application fails verification

3a1. The Administrator determines the application is illegitimate or incomplete.
3a2. The Administrator rejects the application.
3a3. The system maintains the user's current role and notifies them of the rejection.

7.5 William Waweru – Use Cases

7.5.1 UC: Follow Artist – Fan

Use case: Follow Artist
Actor: Fan
Preconditions:

1. The Fan is logged into the system.
2. The Artist has an active account that is visible to the Fan.
3. The Fan is not currently following the Artist.

Postconditions:

1. The Fan is recorded as a follower of the Artist.
2. The Artist is added to the Fan's list of followed Artists.

Main flow:

1. The Fan requests to follow an Artist.
2. The system verifies that the Artist's account is active.
3. The system verifies that the Fan is not already following the Artist.
4. The system creates a following relationship between the Fan and the Artist.
5. The system updates the Artist's follower information.
6. The system confirms that the Fan is now following the Artist.

Extensions:

2a. Artist account is unavailable.

- 2a1. The system determines that the Artist's account is suspended, banned, or otherwise unavailable.
- 2a2. The system does not create the following relationship.
- 2a3. The system informs the Fan that the Artist cannot currently be followed.

3a. Fan already follows the Artist.

- 3a1. The system detects an existing following relationship.
- 3a2. The system does not create a duplicate relationship.
- 3a3. The existing following relationship remains unchanged.

7.5.2 UC: Manage Fan Profile – Fan

Use case: Manage Fan Profile
Actor: Fan
Preconditions:

1. The Fan is logged into the system.
2. The Fan has an existing account and profile.

Postconditions:

1. Valid profile changes are stored by the system.
2. The updated information is associated with the Fan's profile.
3. Profile information is displayed according to the Fan's privacy settings.

Main flow:

1. The Fan requests to modify their profile.
2. The system provides the Fan's existing profile information.
3. The Fan provides updated profile information, such as a biography, artistic interests, supported Artists, or profile image.

4. The Fan specifies applicable privacy preferences.
5. The Fan submits the updated profile information.
6. The system validates the submitted information according to profile and content rules.
7. The system stores the valid changes.
8. The system applies the Fan's privacy preferences to the updated information.
9. The system confirms that the profile has been updated.

Extensions:

6a. Invalid profile information.

6a1. The system identifies invalid profile information.
6a2. The system rejects the affected changes and informs the Fan which information must be corrected.
6a3. The Fan provides corrected information.
6a4. The process resumes at Step 5.

6b. Profile content violates platform rules.

6b1. The system determines that the submitted content violates platform content rules.
6b2. The system rejects the prohibited content.
6b3. The system informs the Fan that the profile cannot be updated with that content.

7a. Profile update cannot be stored.

7a1. The system preserves the previously stored profile information.
7a2. The system informs the Fan that the update was unsuccessful.

7.5.3 UC: Report Inappropriate Content – Fan

Use case: Report Inappropriate Content
Actor: Fan
Preconditions:

1. The Fan is logged into the system.
2. The content or account being reported exists and is accessible to the Fan.

Postconditions:

1. A new report is stored with a pending status.
2. The report contains the reporting Fan, reported content or account, reason, and relevant information.
3. The report is available for Administrator review.

Main flow:

1. The Fan identifies content or user behavior that they believe violates the platform's rules.
2. The Fan requests to report the content or account.
3. The system identifies the content or account associated with the report.
4. The system requests a report reason and any additional relevant information.
5. The Fan provides a reason and submits the report.
6. The system validates that the report contains the required information.
7. The system creates the report and records the relevant information.
8. The system assigns the report a pending status and makes it available for Administrator review.
9. The system confirms to the Fan that the report has been submitted.

Extensions:

3a. Reported content is no longer available.

- 3a1. The system determines that the reported content is no longer publicly available.
- 3a2. If sufficient information about the original content remains available, the system allows the report to continue.
- 3a3. Otherwise, the system informs the Fan that the report cannot be completed.

6a. Report does not contain required information.

- 6a1. The system determines that required report information is missing.
- 6a2. The system does not submit the report.
- 6a3. The system requests the missing information from the Fan.

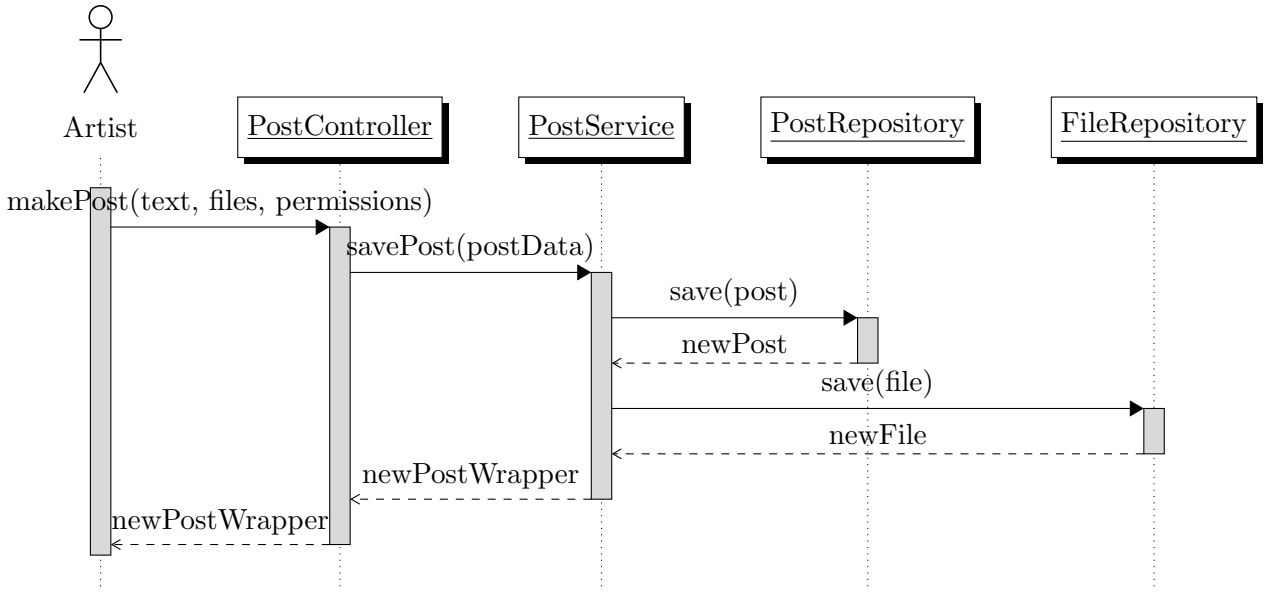
7a. Duplicate report exists.

- 7a1. The system identifies an existing pending report from the same Fan for the same content or account.
- 7a2. The system prevents creation of a duplicate report.
- 7a3. The system informs the Fan that they have already reported the content or account.

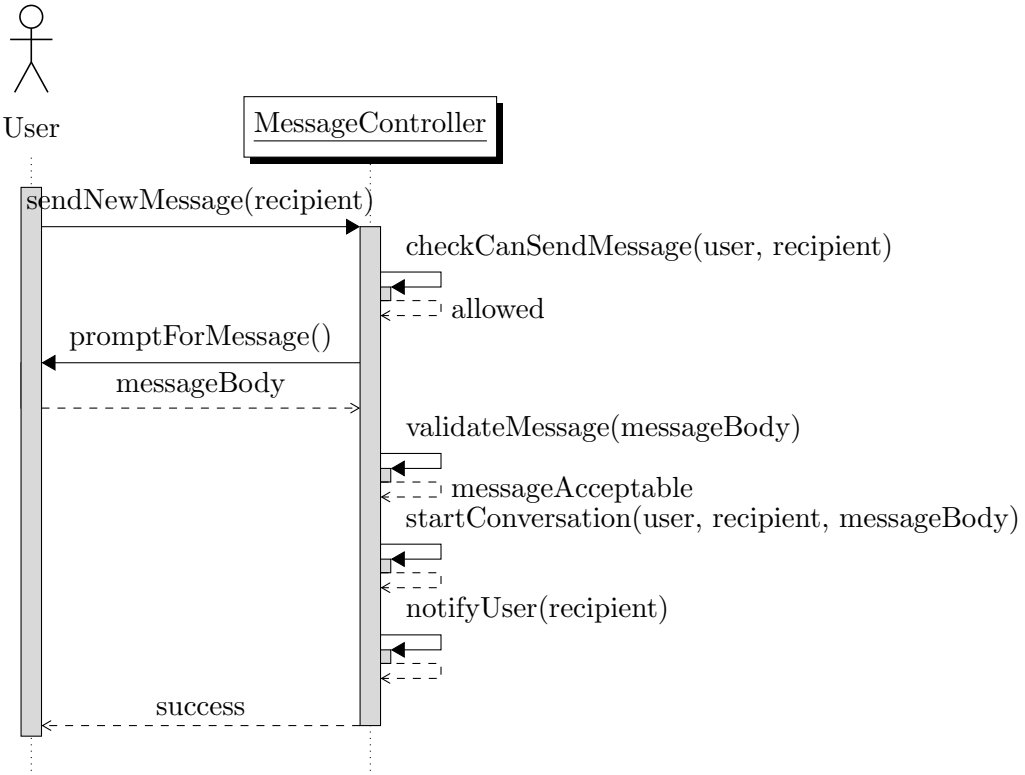
8. Sequence Diagrams

8.1 Garrett DeYong – Sequence Diagrams

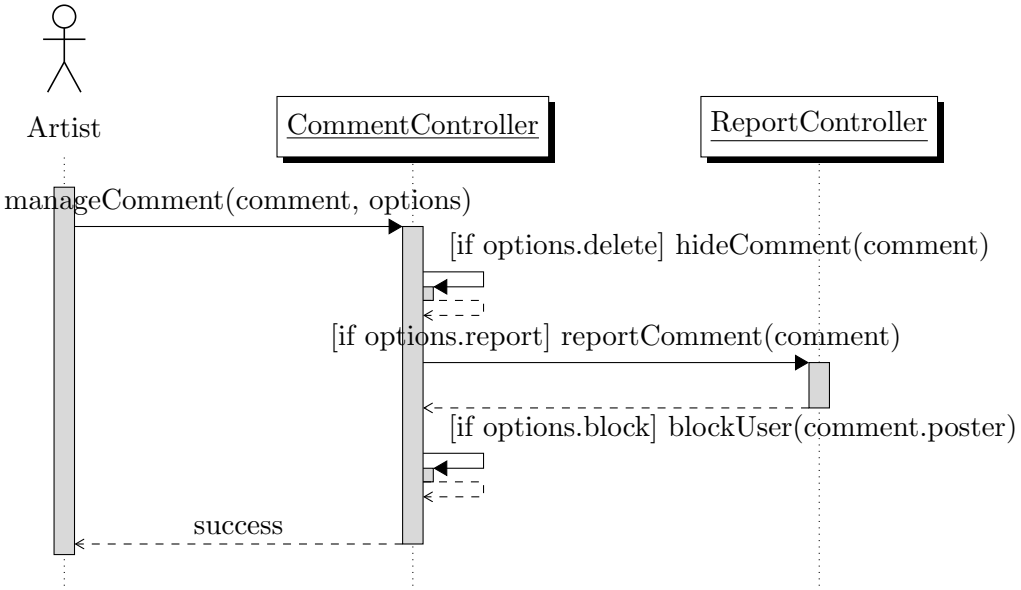
Artist - Make a post



Artist/Fan - Message another user

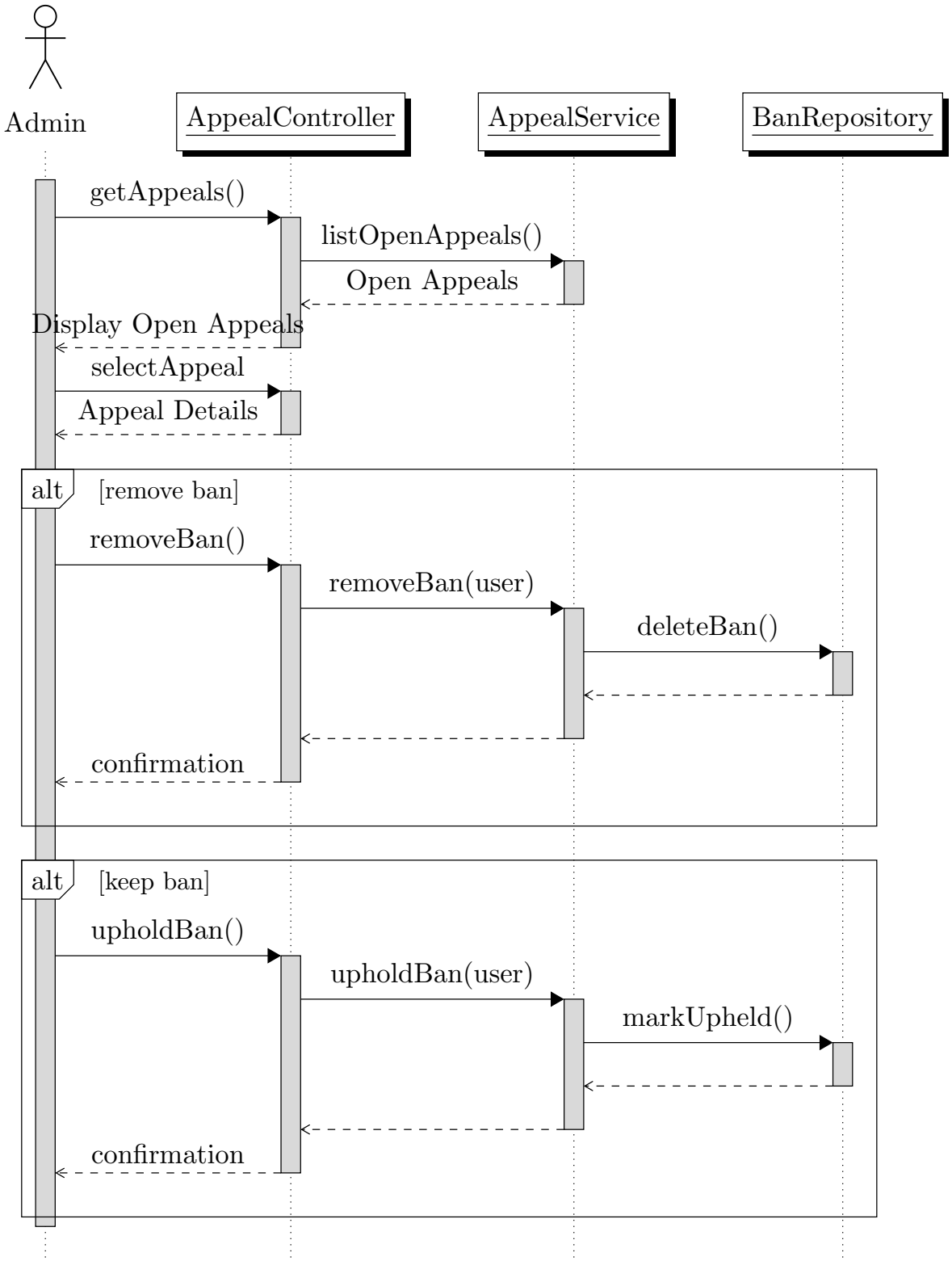


Artist - Monitor comments

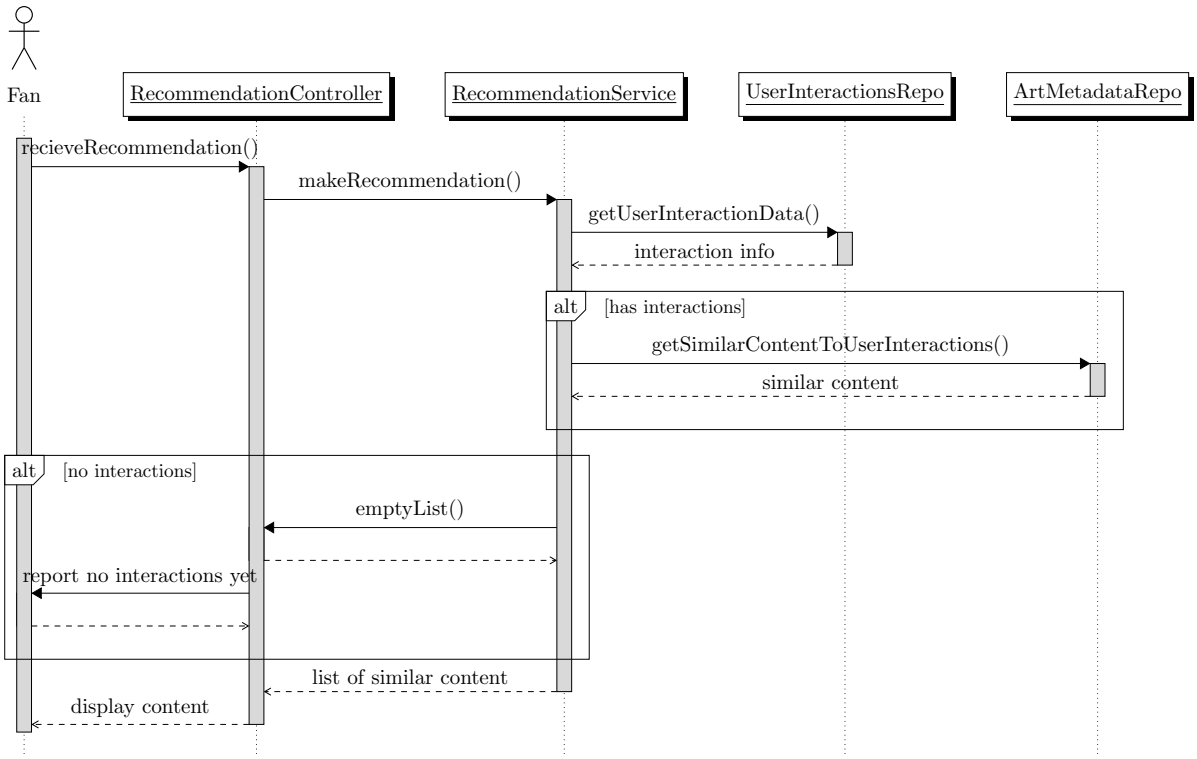


8.2 Nicholas Nolen – Sequence Diagrams

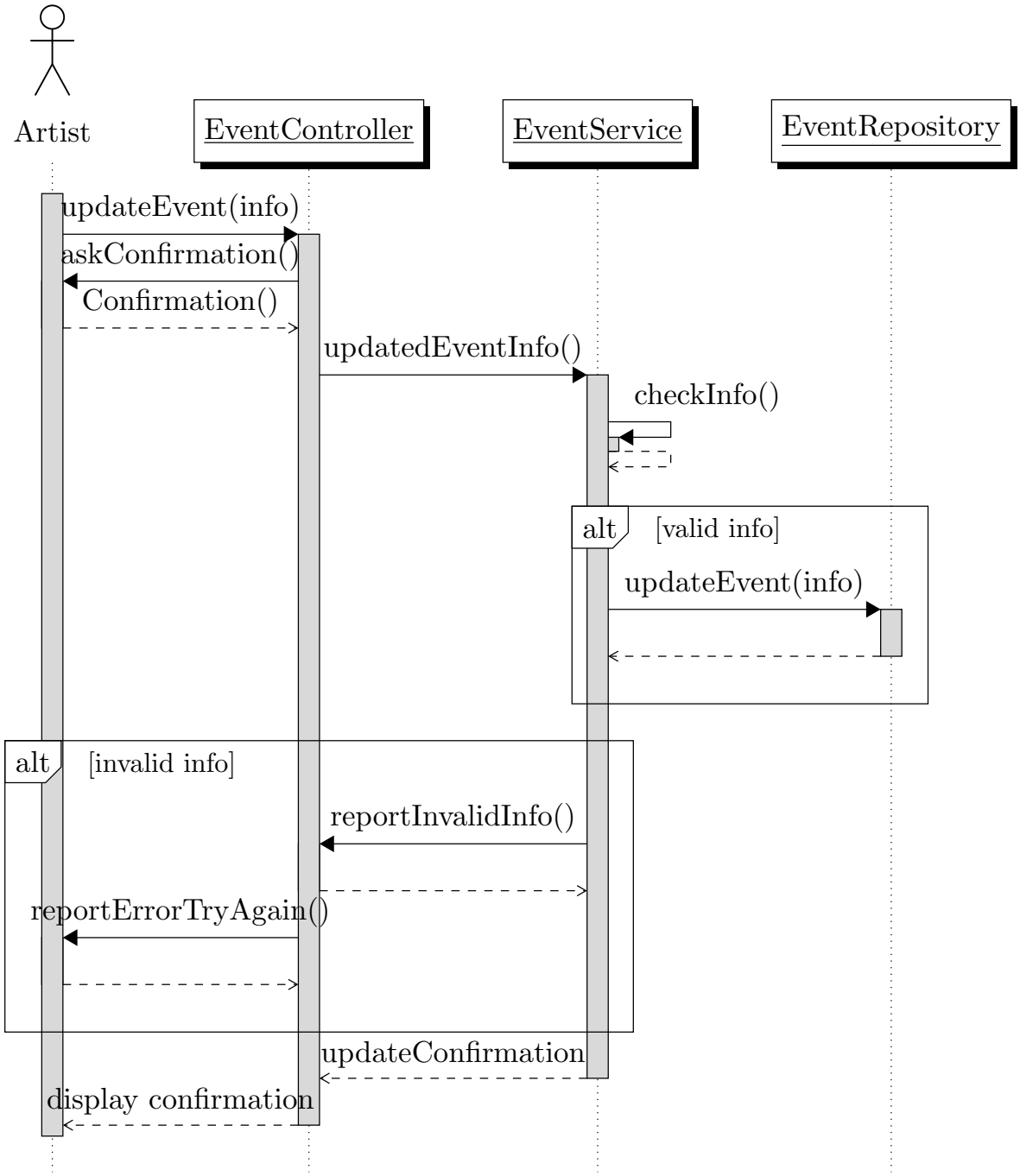
Admin - Unban Fan (Appeals)



Fan - Receive Recommendation

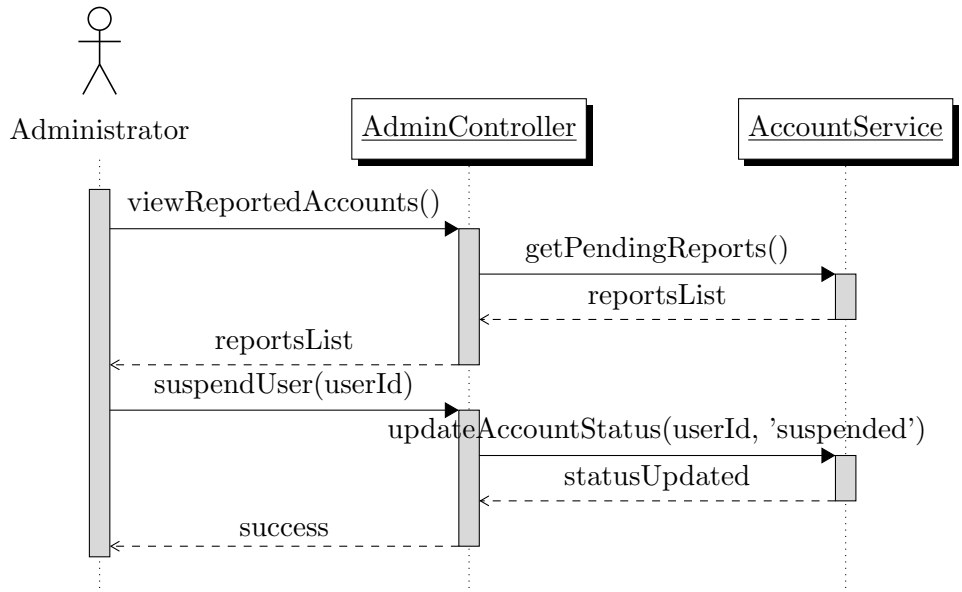


Artist - Update Event

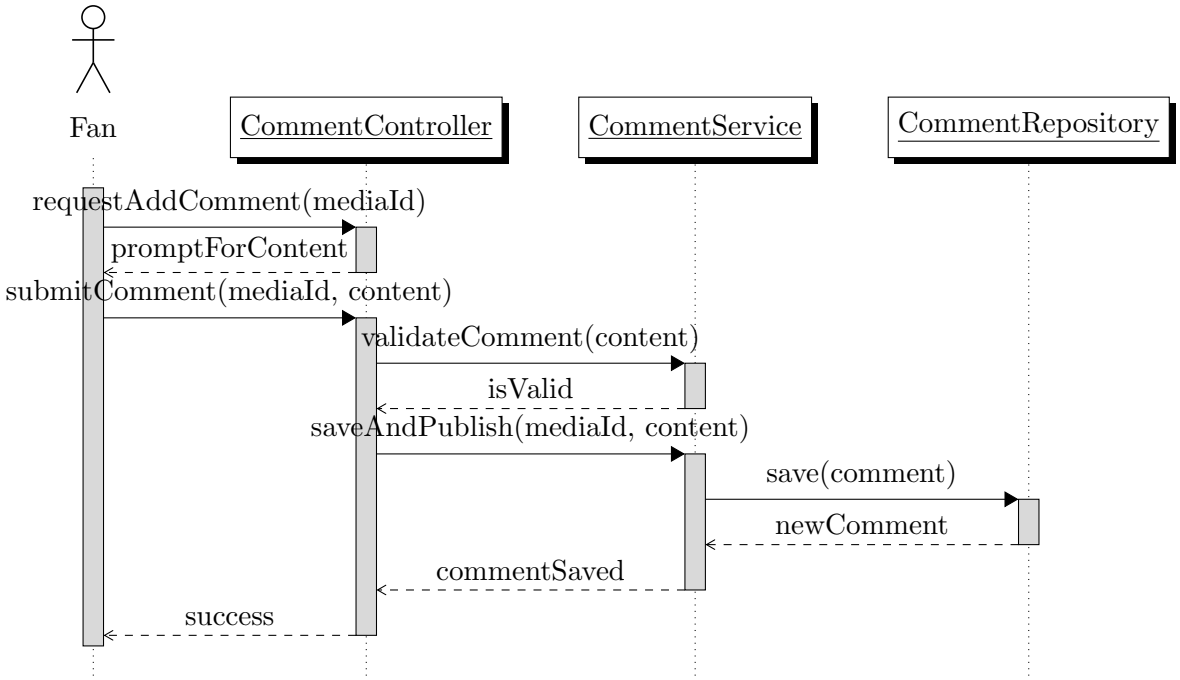


8.3 Gan-Orgil Gantumur – Sequence Diagrams

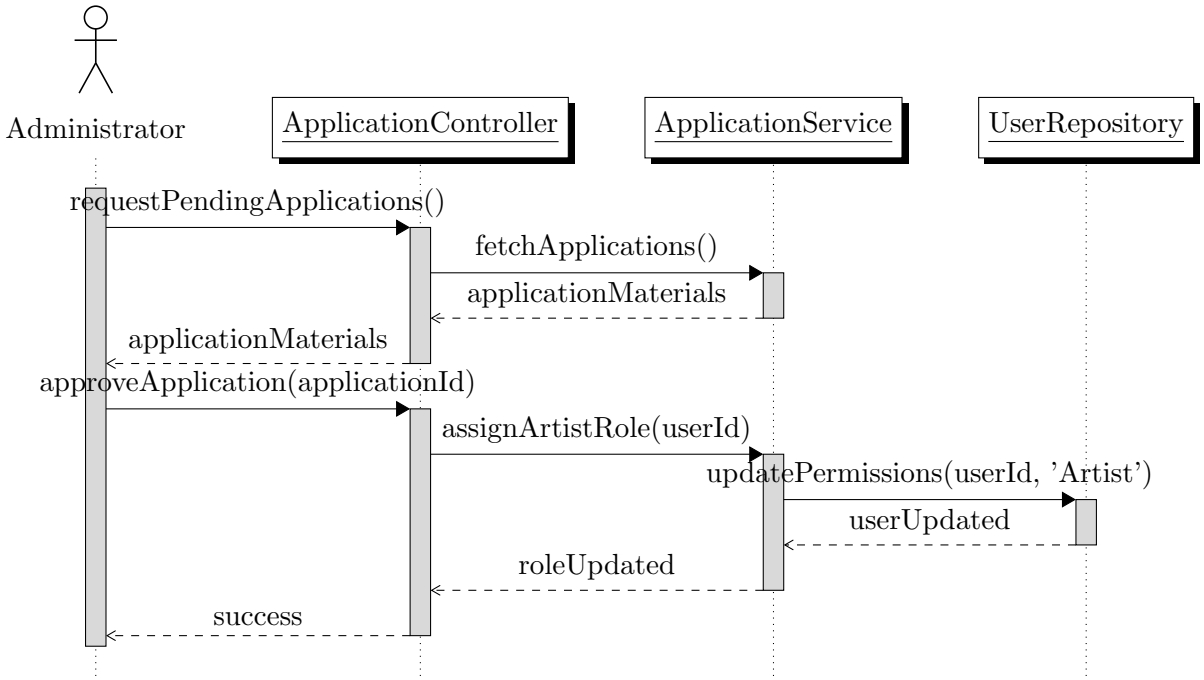
Administrator - Suspending Artist Account



Fan - Comment on Artwork

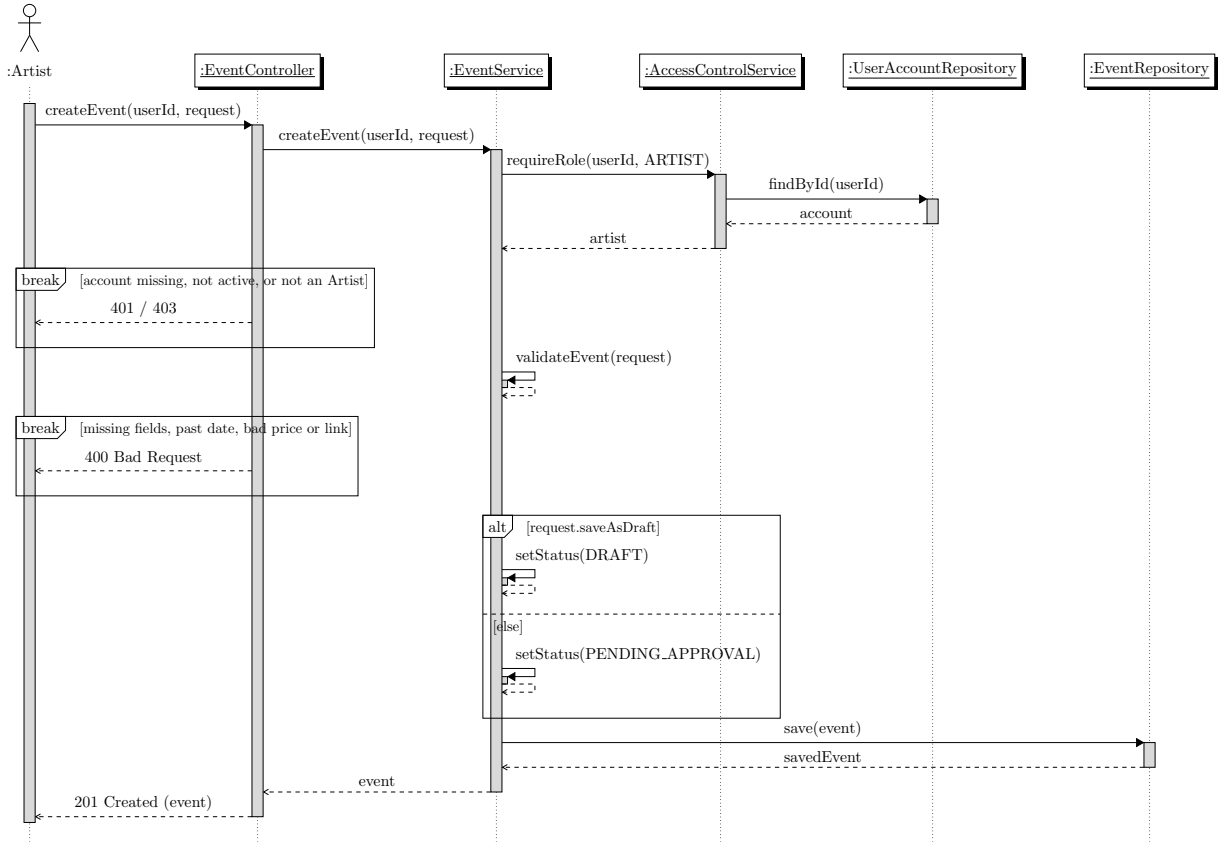


Administrator - Approve Artist Verification Application

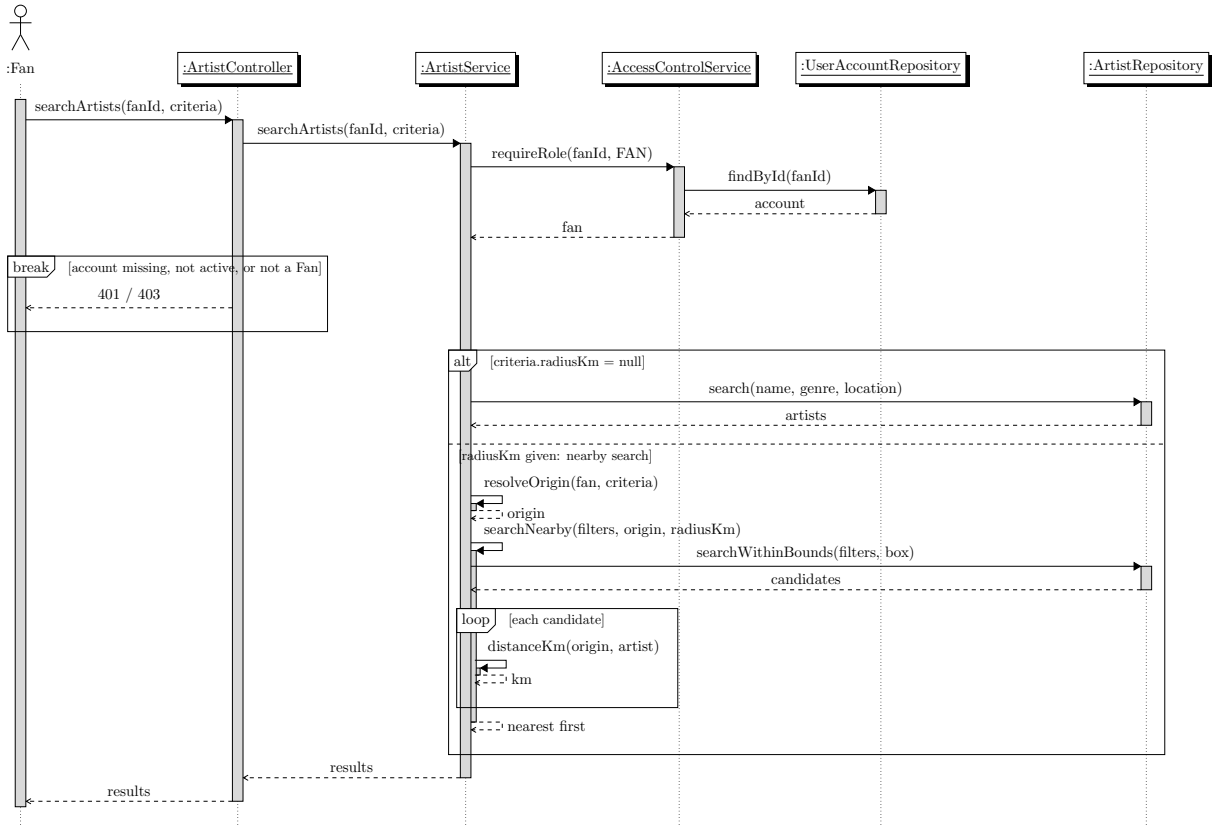


8.4 Alex Garcia – Sequence Diagrams

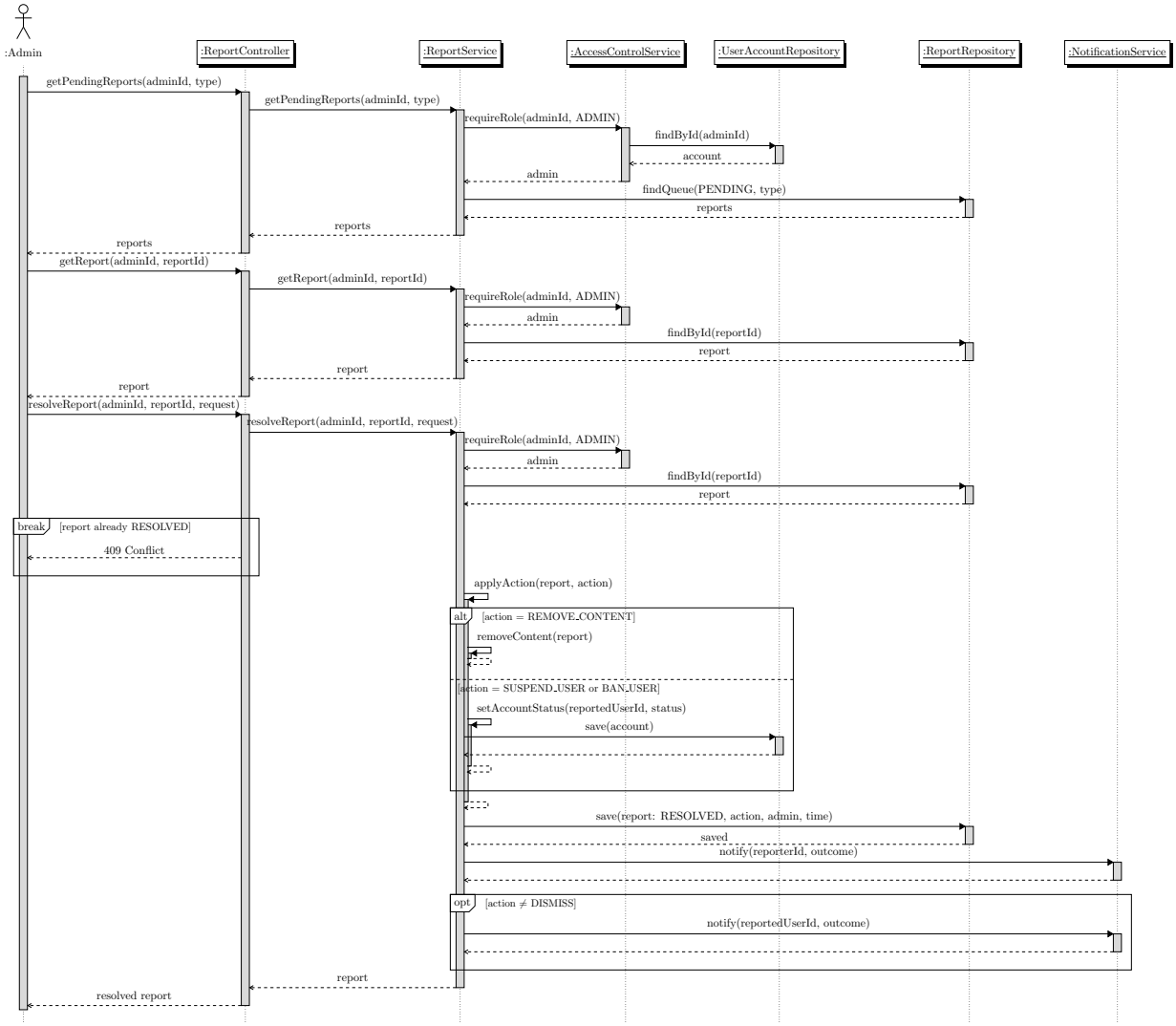
Artist – Create Event



Fan – Search for Artist

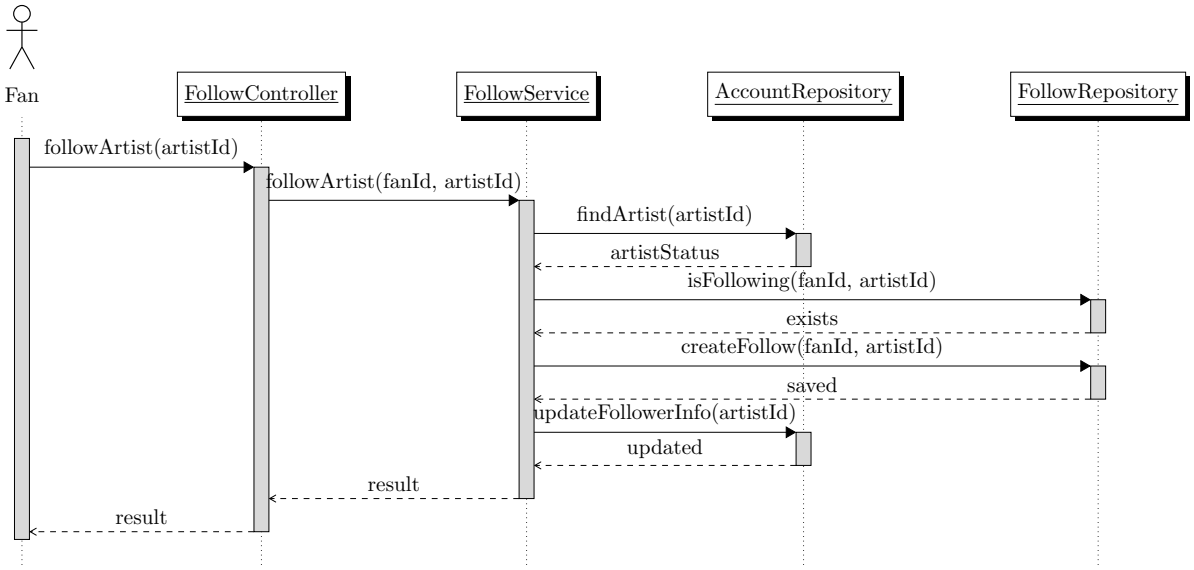


Admin – Review Report

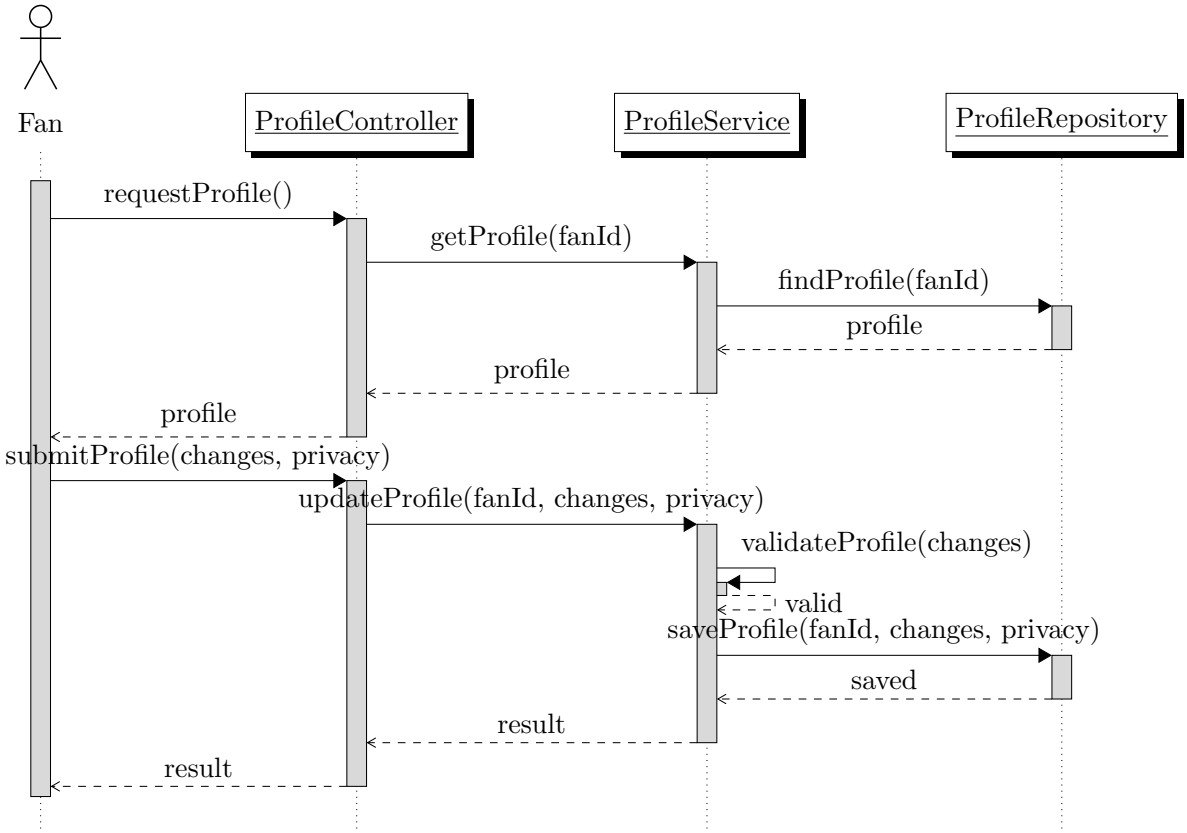


8.5 William Waweru – Sequence Diagrams

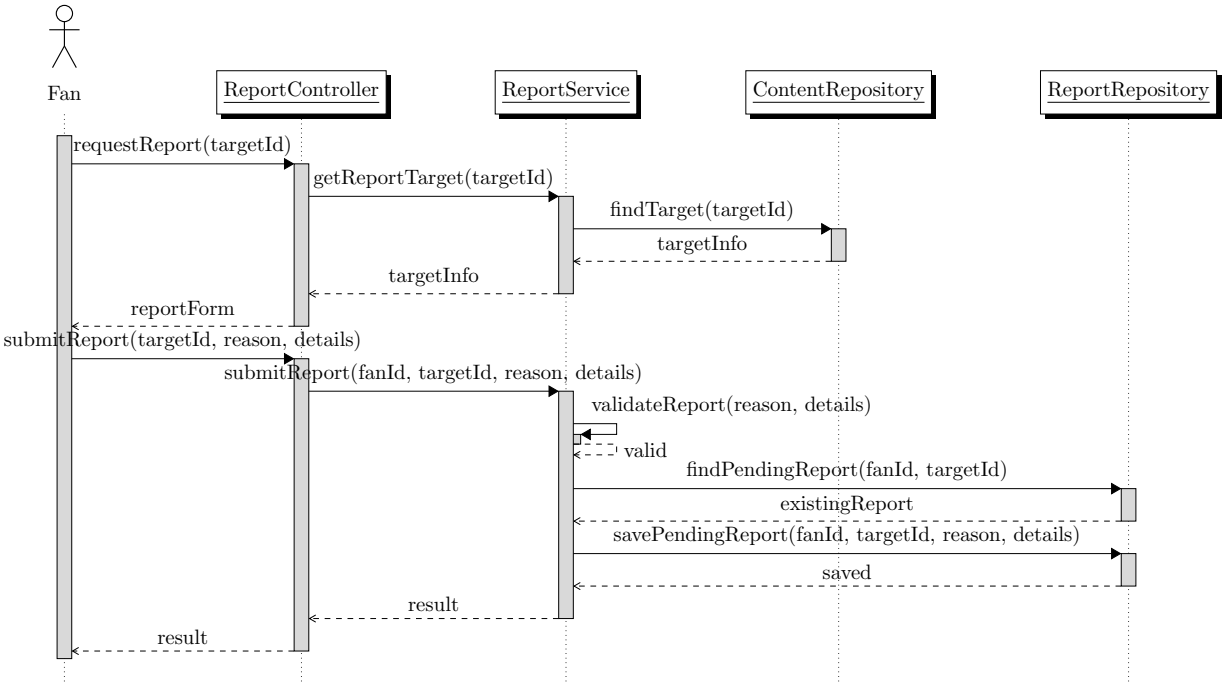
8.5.1 Follow Artist – Fan



8.5.2 Manage Fan Profile – Fan



8.5.3 Report Inappropriate Content – Fan



9. Use Case Diagram

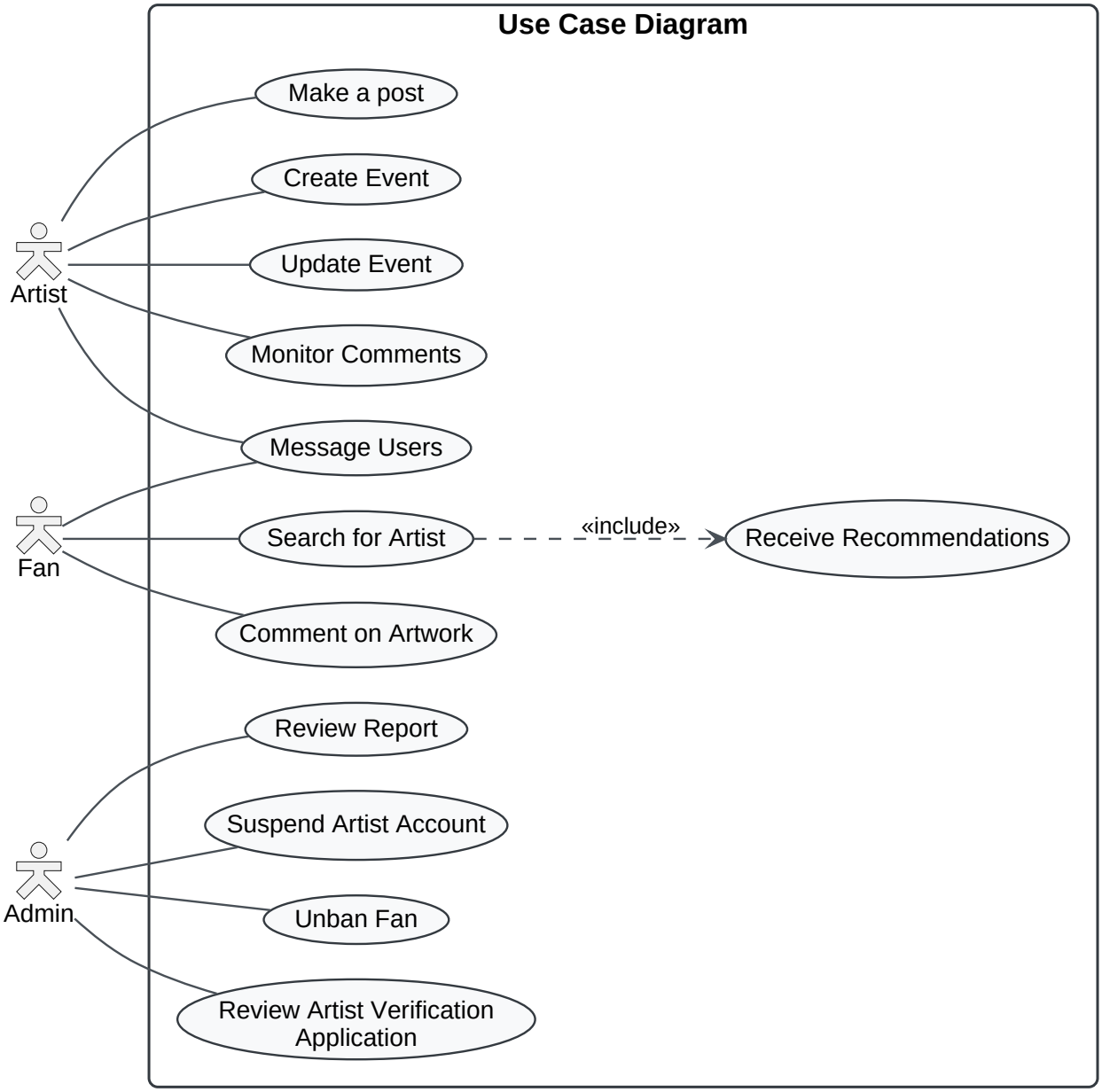
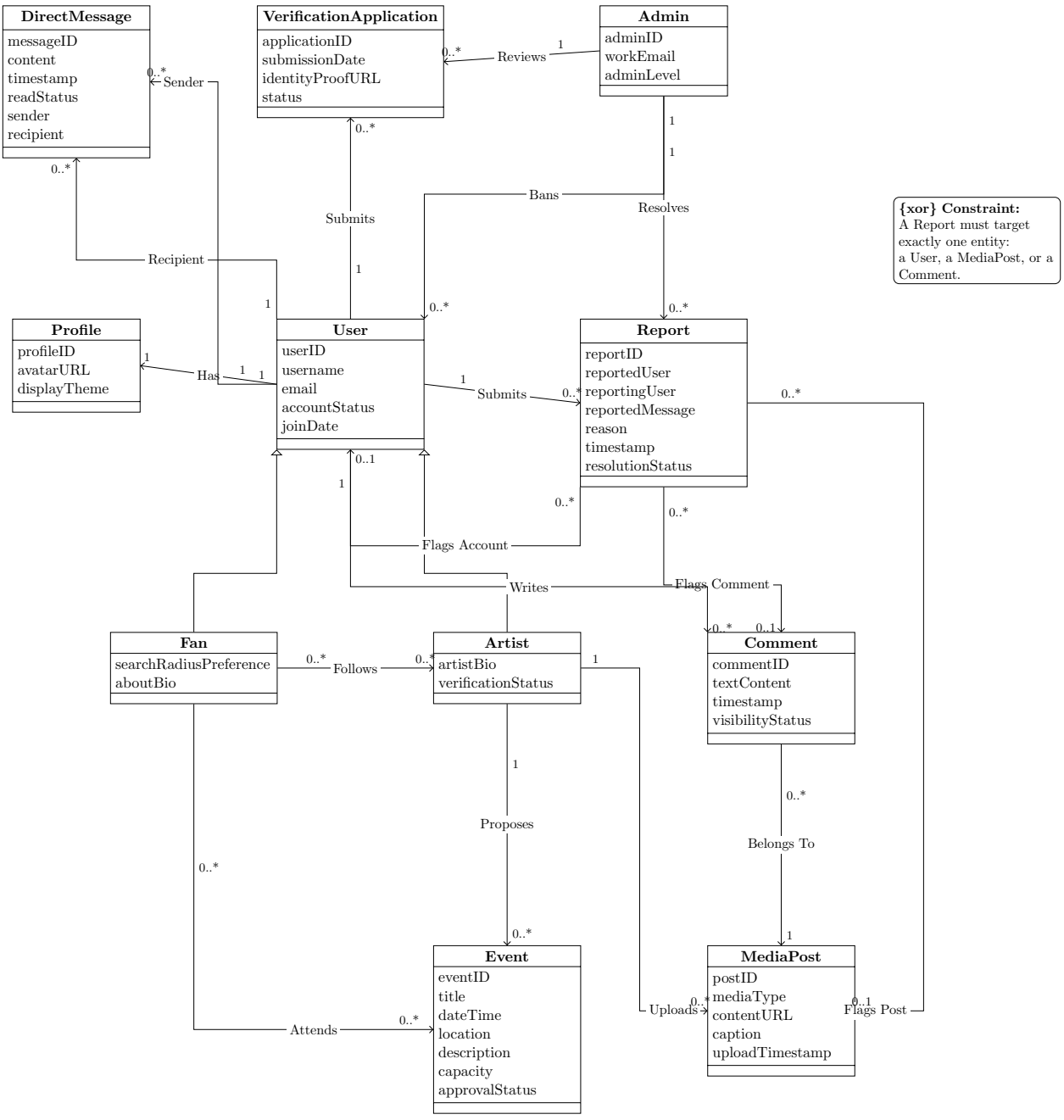
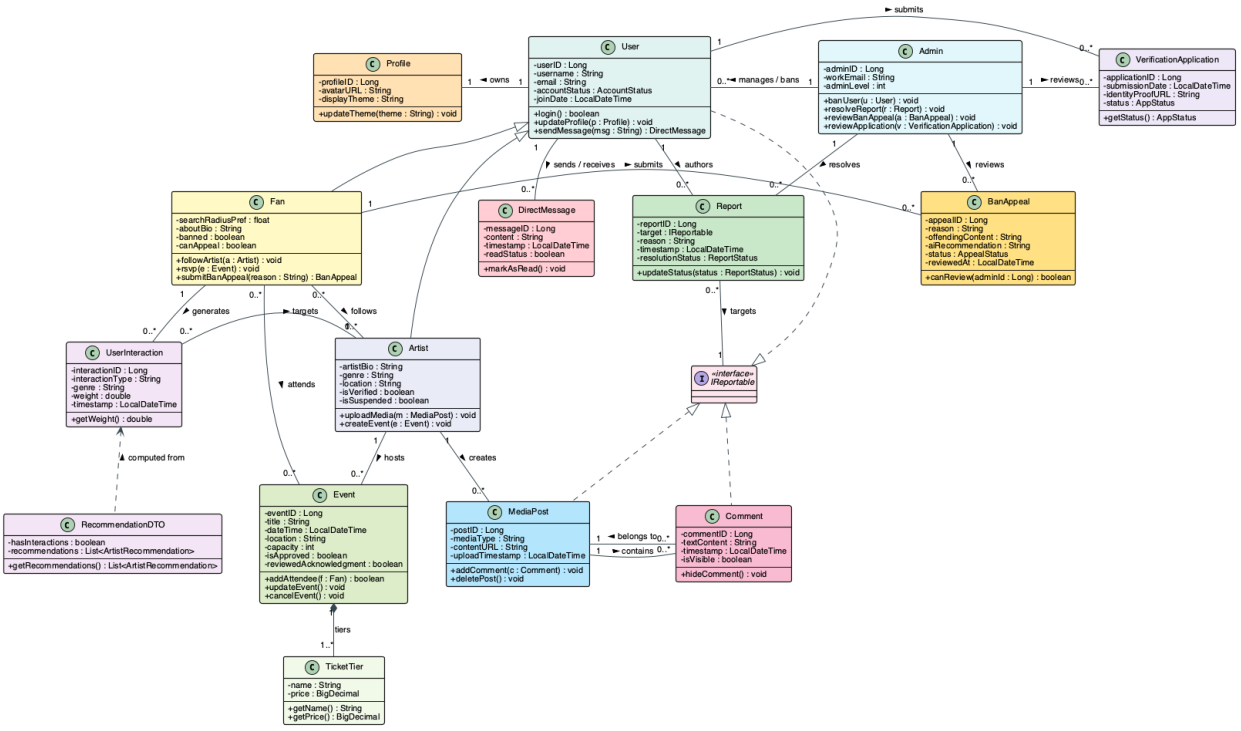


Figure 9.1: System Use Case Diagram

10. Domain Model



11. Design Class Diagram

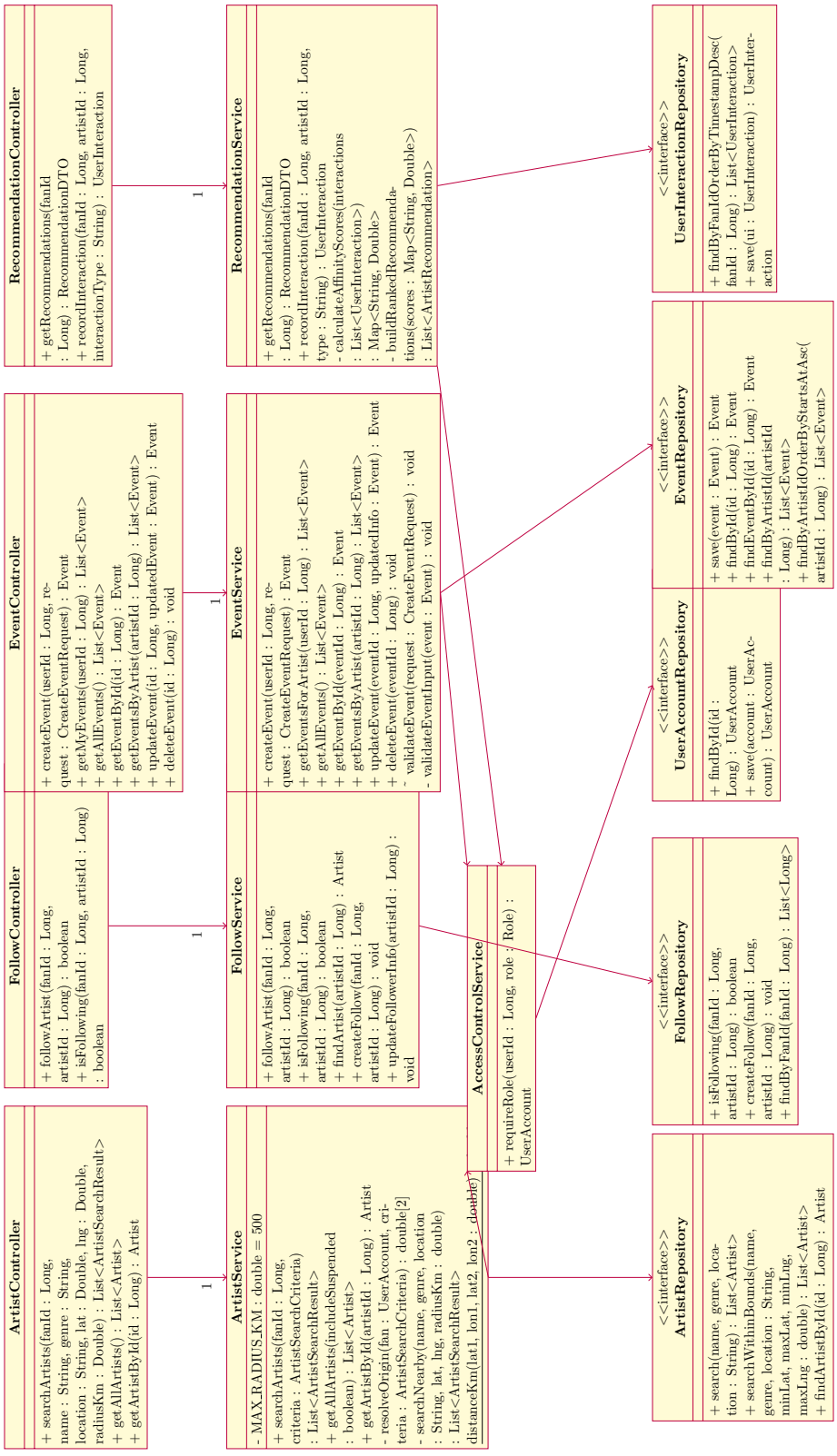


11.1 Design Class Specifications

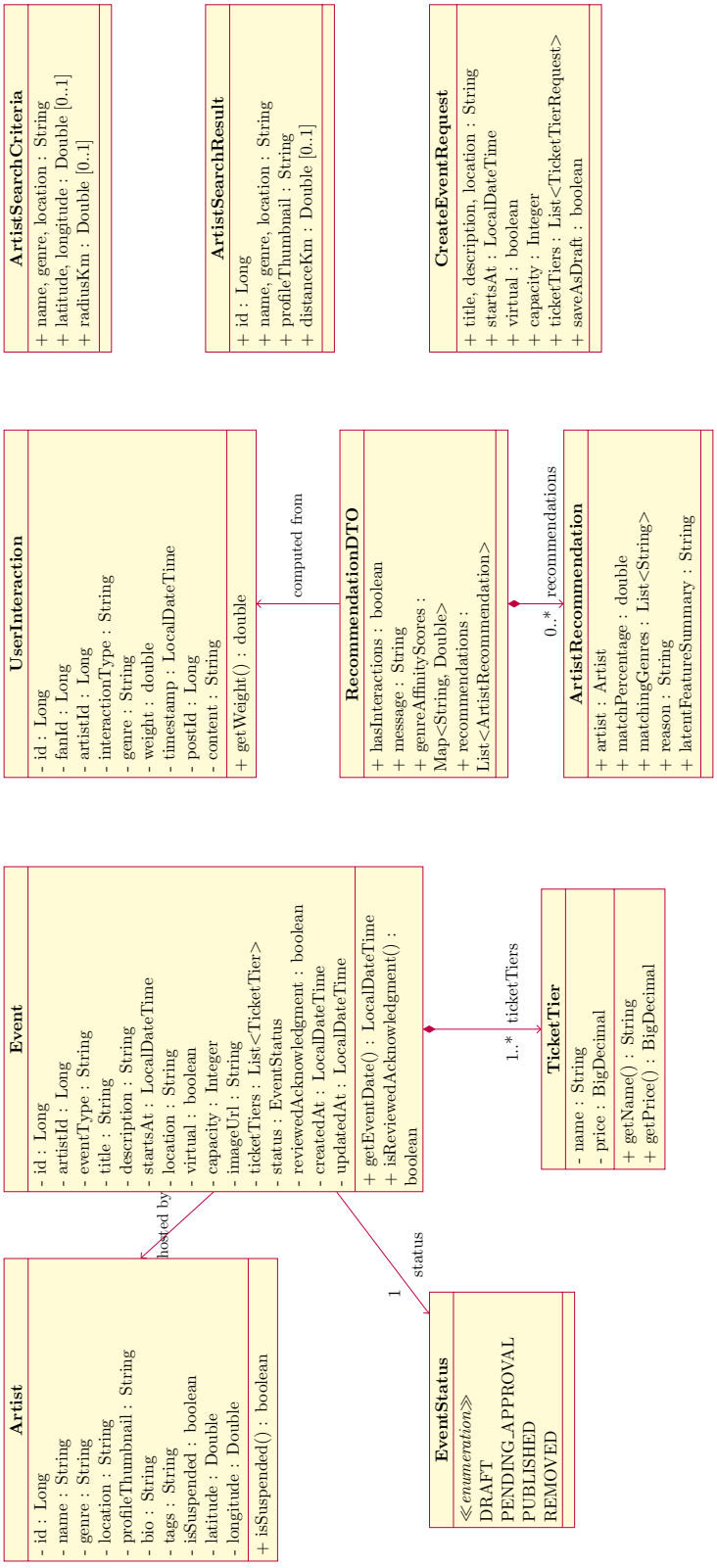
The design class model refines the conceptual domain model into concrete software components supporting all system use cases implemented across the platform to date (artist search and proximity discovery, event authoring and updating, personalized recommendations, content reporting, and fan ban appeals). All operations are secured via `AccessControlService.requireRole`, enforcing role-based permissions and active account verification across Fan, Artist, and Admin workflows.

11.1.1 Discovery, Following, Events, and Personalized Recommendations

Controllers, Services, and Repositories

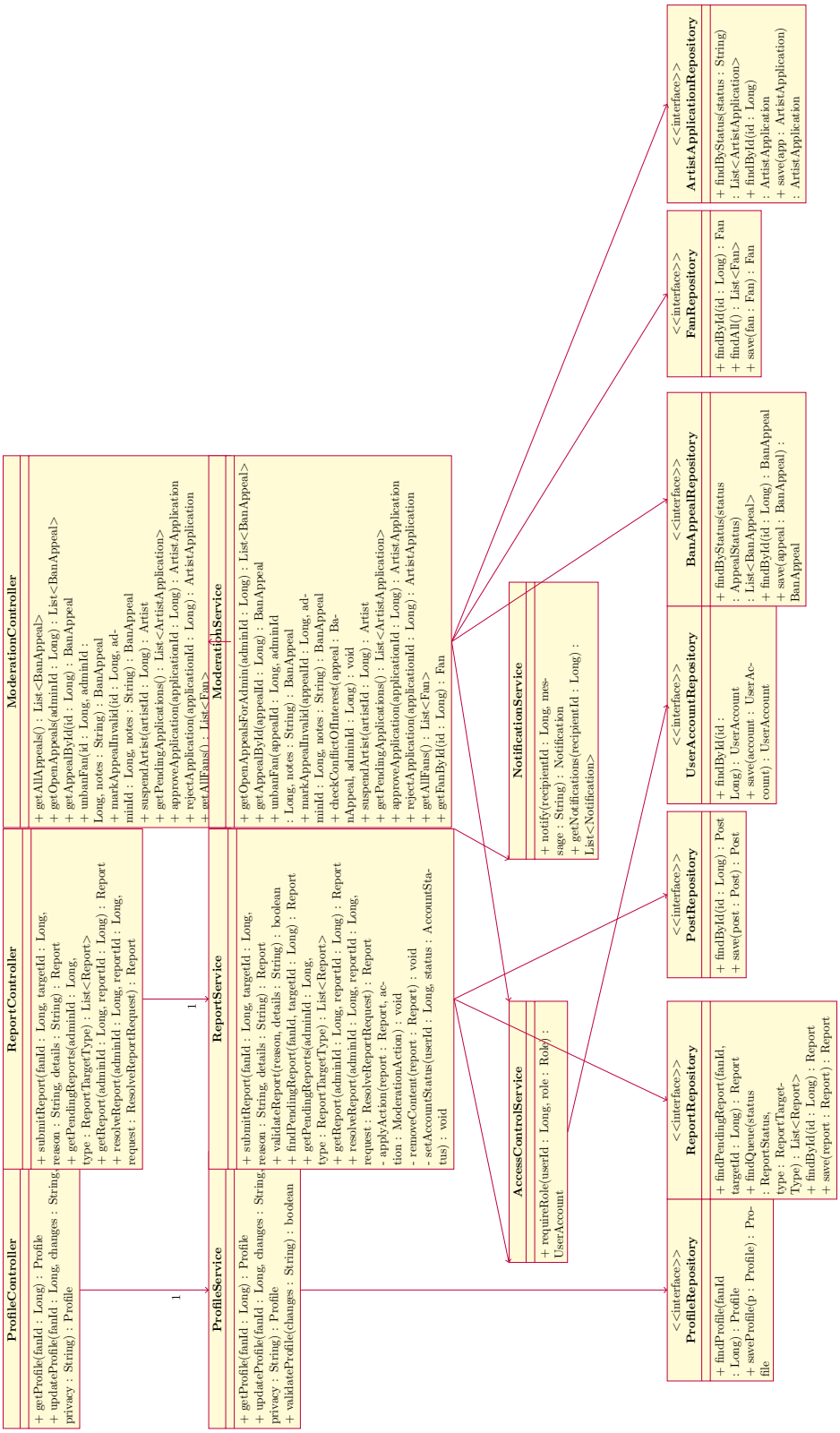


Entities, Request/Response Objects, and Enumerations

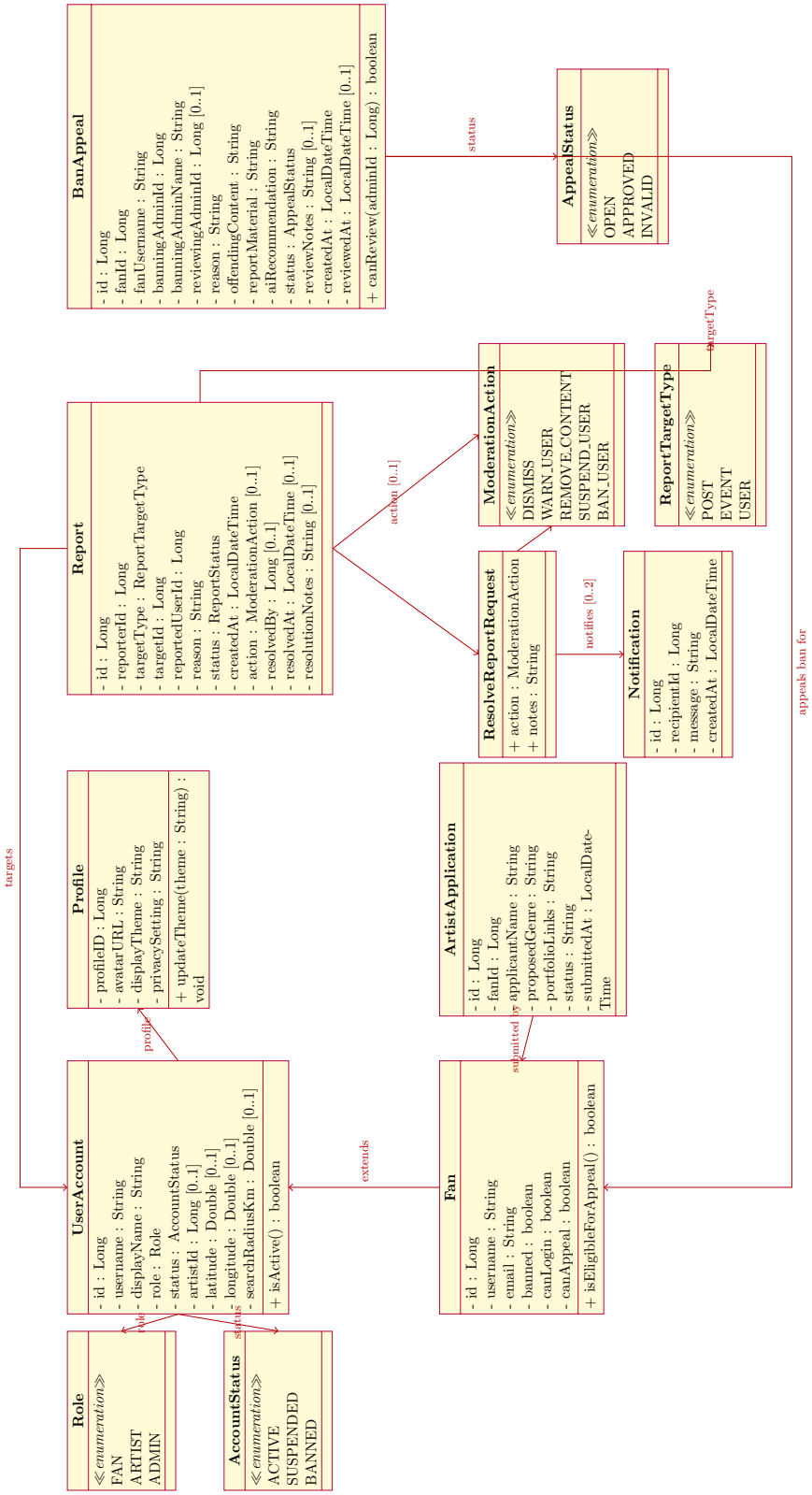


11.1.2 User Profiles, Moderation, Fan Ban Appeals, and Verification

Controllers, Services, and Repositories

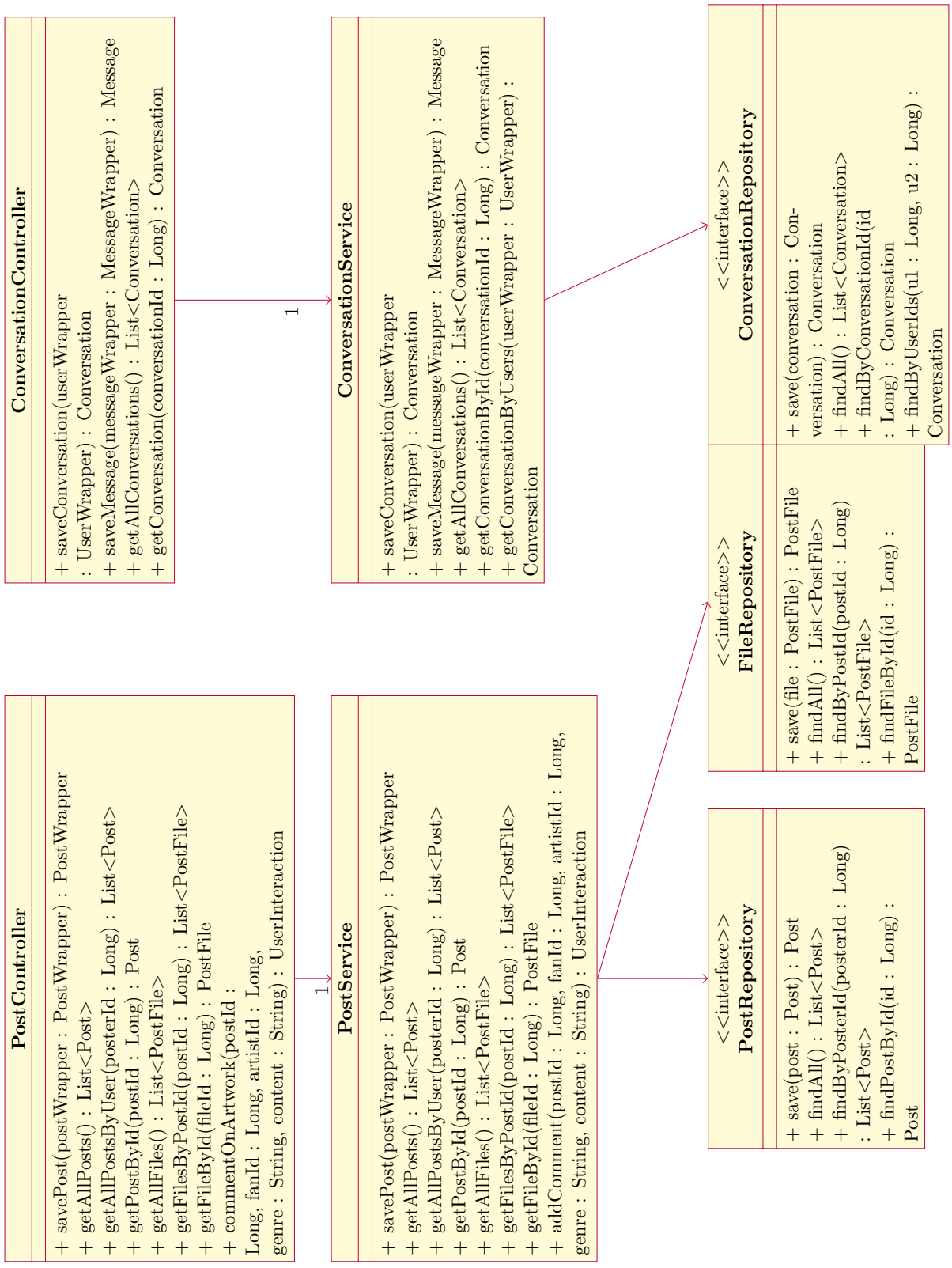


Entities, Request/Response Objects, and Enumerations

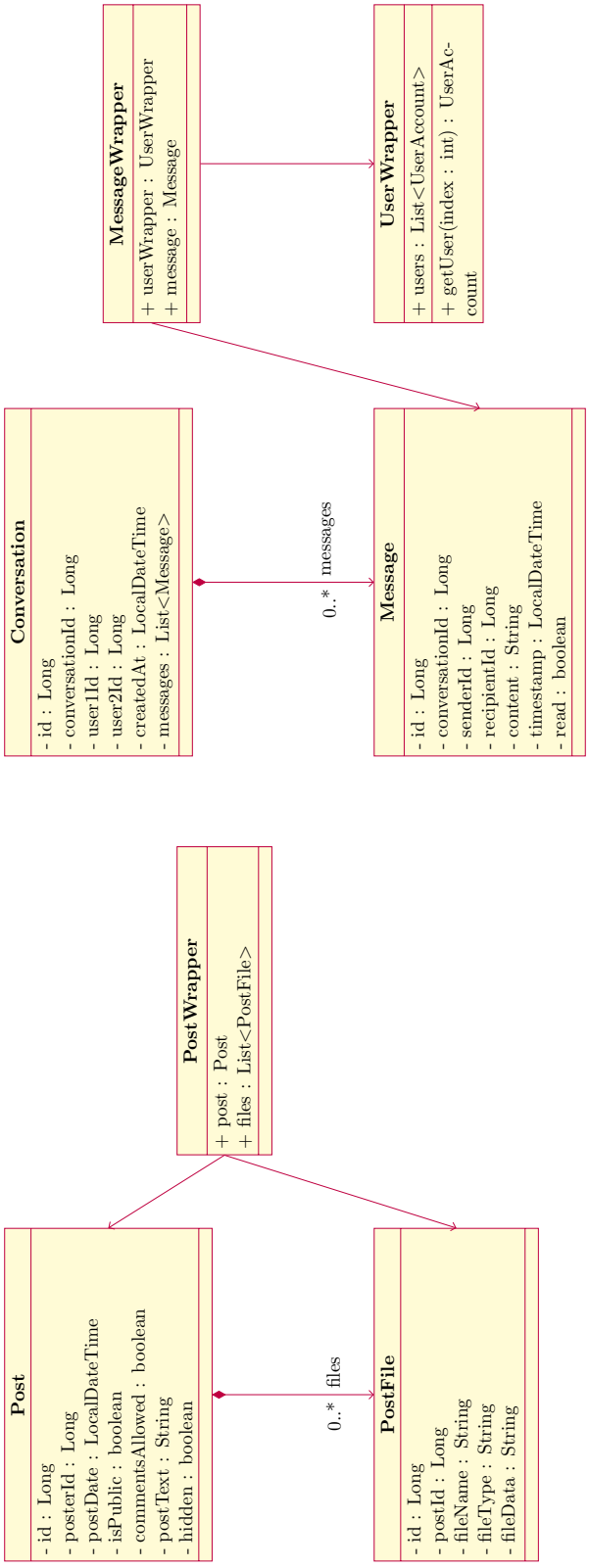


11.1.3 Community Posts, Media Attachments, and Direct Messaging

Controllers, Services, and Repositories



Entities, Wrappers, and Attachments



12. Operation Contracts

Operation: searchArtists(fanId: Long, criteria: ArtistSearchCriteria): List⟨ArtistSearchResult⟩

Cross Reference

UC: Search for Artist – Fan

Preconditions

- A UserAccount instance identified by `fanId` exists with `role` = FAN and `status` = ACTIVE.

Postconditions

- A collection of Artist instances matching every given criterion (name, genre, location) was retrieved.
- If `criteria.radiusKm` was given, only Artist instances within that distance of the search origin (the given coordinates, or else the Fan's saved `latitude`/`longitude`) were retrieved, ordered by distance.
- No instances were created, deleted, or modified (read-only operation).

Operation: resolveReport(adminId: Long, reportId: Long, request: ResolveReportRequest): Report

Cross Reference

UC: Review Report – Admin

Preconditions

- A UserAccount instance identified by `adminId` exists with `role` = ADMIN and `status` = ACTIVE.
- A Report instance identified by `reportId` exists with `status` = PENDING.

Postconditions

- The Report instance's `status` was changed to RESOLVED, and its `action`, `resolvedBy` (the Admin), `resolvedAt`, and `resolutionNotes` were set.
- If `action` = REMOVE_CONTENT, the reported Post's `hidden` was set to true, or the reported Event's `status` was changed to REMOVED.
- If `action` = SUSPEND_USER or BAN_USER, the reported UserAccount's `status` was changed to SUSPENDED or BANNED respectively.
- A new Notification instance was created for the reporting user.
- If `action` ≠ DISMISS, a new Notification instance was created for the reported user.

Operation: createEvent(userId: Long, request: CreateEventRequest): Event

Cross Reference

UC: Create Event – Artist

Preconditions

- A UserAccount instance identified by `userId` exists with `role` = ARTIST, `status` = ACTIVE, and a linked Artist profile.

Postconditions

- A new Event instance was created with `title`, `description`, `startsAt`, `location`, `virtual`, and `capacity` set from `request`.
- One TicketTier instance was created for each tier in `request` and associated with the new Event.
- The new Event was associated with the Artist profile of the requesting account.
- The new Event's `status` was set to DRAFT if `request.saveAsDraft` is true, otherwise to PENDING_APPROVAL.

13. Test Cases

13.1 Test Cases for Iteration 1

No test cases were produced during iteration one.

13.2 Test Cases for Iteration 2

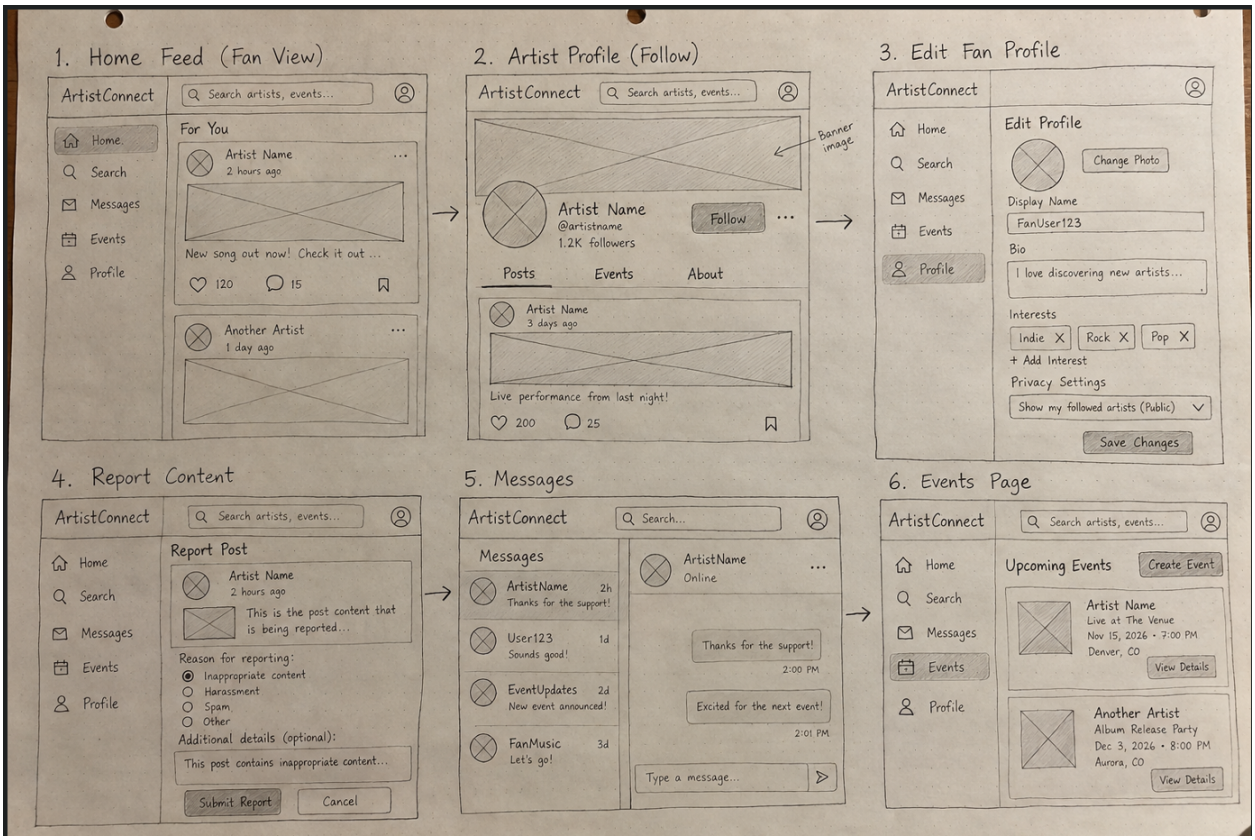
- Artist Search
- Unban Fan
- Edit Event

Search for Artist, Create Event, Review Report (automated, `backend/src/test`)

ID	Use case	Scenario	Expected result
SA-1	Search for Artist	Fan searches by name, genre, or location	Only matching artists returned
SA-2	Search for Artist (3a)	Fan submits no criteria	400, asks for a criterion
SA-3	Search for Artist	Fan searches within 100 km / 200 km of saved home (Waco)	Nearby artists only, nearest first, with distance
SA-4	Search for Artist (3b)	Fan shares coordinates in Austin and filters by genre	Matching artist under 1 km away
SA-5	Search for Artist (3c)	Nearby search with no shared or saved location	400, asks for a location
SA-6	Search for Artist	Radius of 0 or over 500 km	400
SA-7	Search for Artist (*a)	No account, Artist, or Admin tries to search	401 / 403
CE-1	Create Event	Artist submits a valid event with two tiers	201, status PENDING_APPROVAL
CE-2	Create Event (4a)	Artist saves a draft	201, status DRAFT, listed in artist's events
CE-3	Create Event (5a, 5b)	Missing title, past date, no tiers, negative price, zero capacity, virtual without link	400, nothing saved

ID	Use case	Scenario	Expected result
CE-4	Create Event (*a)	No account, unknown account, Fan, or Admin tries to create	401 / 403, nothing saved
CE-5	Create Event (*a)	Suspended Artist tries to create	403
RR-1	Review Report	Admin opens the queue, filters by type	Pending reports, oldest first
RR-2	Review Report (*a)	Fan or Artist opens queue or resolves	401 / 403, nothing changed
RR-3	Review Report	Admin removes a reported post / event	Post hidden / event REMOVED, both users notified
RR-4	Review Report (5a)	Admin dismisses a report	Only reporter notified
RR-5	Review Report (5b)	Admin bans the reported user	Account BANNED and blocked from artist actions
RR-6	Review Report (3a)	Admin resolves an already resolved report	409
RR-7	Review Report (5c)	Remove content on a user report; unknown report; missing action	400 / 404 / 400

14. UI Mockups



14.1 Make a Post – Artist

Figure 14.1 shows the artist's post creation interface, including the story field, media upload control, visibility settings, comment preferences, and a live preview.

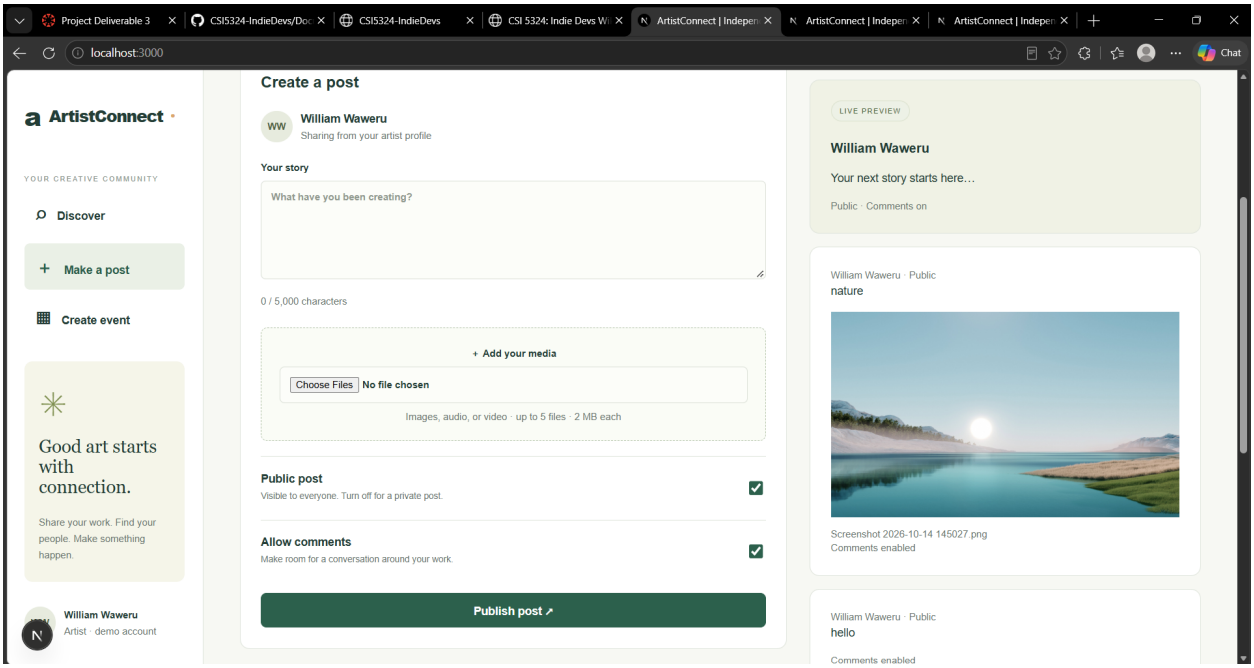


Figure 14.1: ArtistConnect UI preview for the Make a Post use case.

14.2 Search for Artist – Fan

Figure 14.2 shows the artist discovery interface, where a fan can search using artist name, genre or style, and location, then view matching artist profiles.

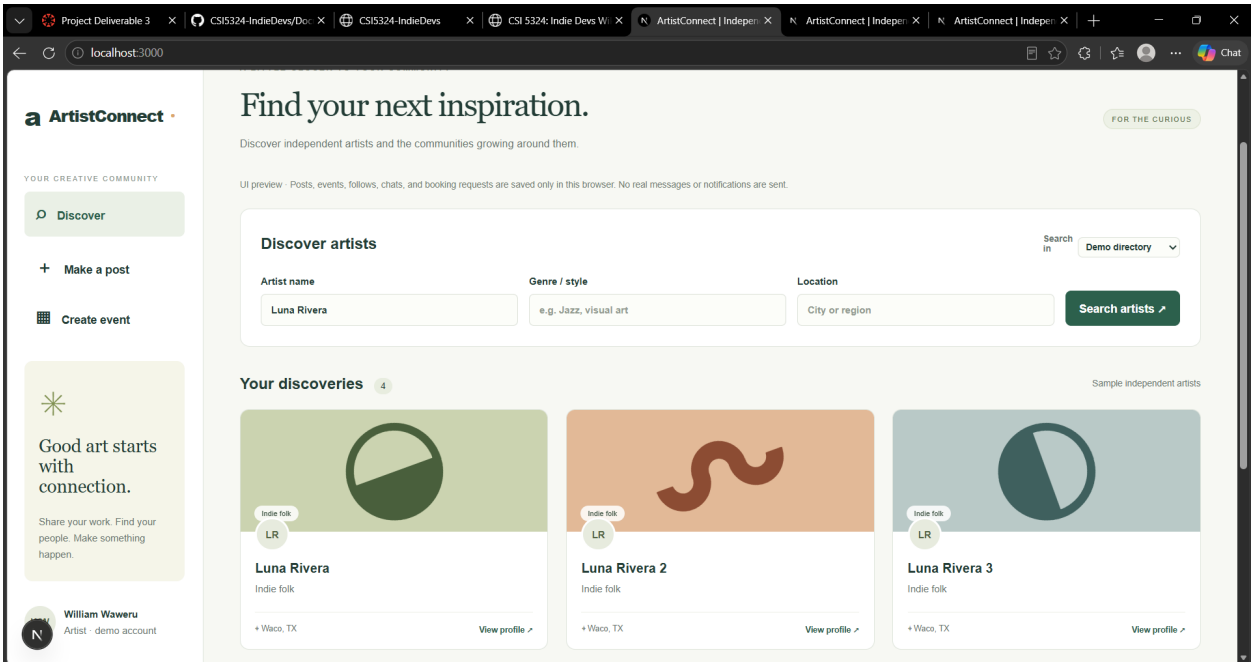


Figure 14.2: ArtistConnect UI preview for the Search for Artist use case.

14.3 Create Event – Artist

Figure 14.3 shows the event creation interface, including event details, venue, capacity, description, ticket tiers, and draft or review submission actions.

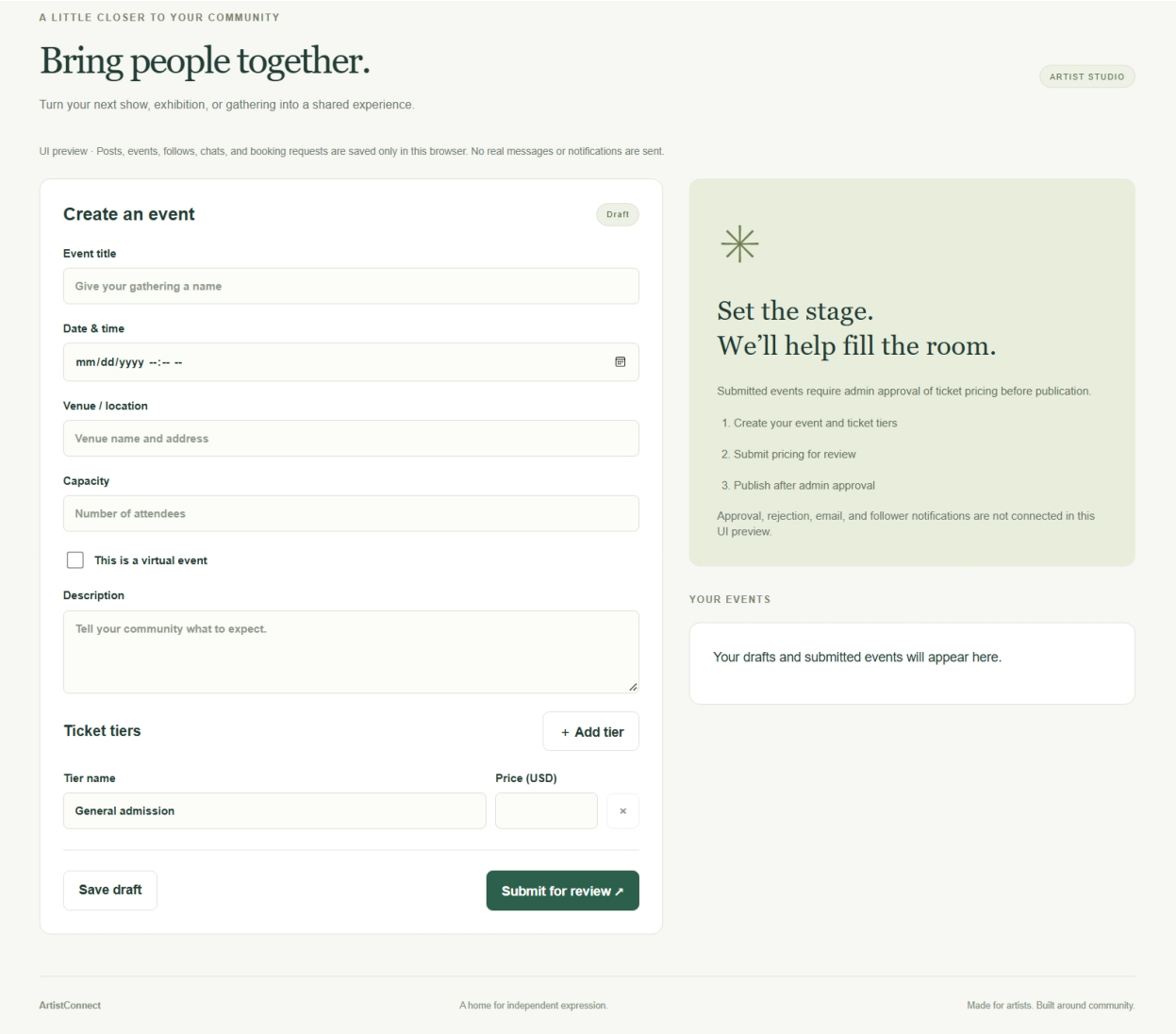


Figure 14.3: ArtistConnect UI preview for the Create Event use case.